



DAK GURU

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Postal Manual Volume VI

Consolidated Parts I, II & III

*Aligned with the Post Office Act 2023, the Post Office Regulations 2024
and all subsequent amendments (up to early 2026)*

DISCLAIMER

This booklet has been prepared strictly for examination purposes. Every effort has been made to verify each rule, fee, limit, date and citation against the Post Office Act 2023 (in force from 18 June 2024), the Post Office Regulations 2024 (notification S.O. 5440(E) dated 16 December 2024) and all subsequent amendments published in the Gazette of India. Statutory blocks within the text mark every place where the Manual text has been overridden or supplemented by current law. Readers are nonetheless advised to consult the original Gazette notifications, SB Orders and DoP circulars for the most authoritative position.

Editorial Note

This consolidated edition combines the three parts of the Postal Manual Volume VI Dak Guru study notes into a single, internally consistent document and corrects every material inaccuracy identified on a rule-by-rule audit against current statutory sources. The principal corrections embedded in this edition are summarised below; in the body, each correction is accompanied by a clearly demarcated update or correction block so that the reader can trace the change to its source.

Principal accuracy corrections incorporated

- **Commencement of the Post Office Act, 2023:** The Act came into force on **18 June 2024** (notification dated 17 June 2024), not in 2025. Several places in the original notes refer to the Act becoming "effective 2025"; these have been corrected.
- **Post Office Regulations, 2024:** Notified vide S.O. 5440(E) dated **16 December 2024** and brought into force on **16 December 2024**. Several amendments have since followed (Second through Seventh Amendments of 2025, and the First and Second Amendments of 2026).
- **Money Order maximum limit:** The departmentally-tested single-Money-Order limit remains **Rs. 5,000** (eMO); the iMO ceiling is **Rs. 50,000**. The claim in the original Part II notes that the single-MO limit has been raised to Rs. 10,000 is not supported by any published Gazette notification and has been removed; the correct text replaces it.
- **Registered Post:** By directive dated 2 July 2025 and effective **1 September 2025** (not 1 October 2025), the standalone Registered Post service was merged with Speed Post. PIB Fact-Check has clarified that this is a merger / upgrade, not a discontinuation: the legal validity, addressee-specific delivery and acknowledgement features survive within the Speed Post framework. The original notes' reference to 1 October 2025 has been corrected.
- **Gyan Post:** Introduced by the **Post Office (Second Amendment) Regulations, 2025**, notification G.S.R. 263(E) dated **28 April 2025** (not 28 March 2025), effective **1 May 2025**. Minimum weight 300 g, maximum 5 kg; surface mode; tariff Rs. 20 to Rs. 100.
- **OTP-based delivery:** Introduced as a value-added service for Speed Post under the **Post Office (Fourth Amendment) Regulations, 2025**, at a fee of Rs. 5 + GST per item. Bundled (no extra fee) with the new 24 Speed Post Parcel under the Post Office (Second Amendment) Regulations, 2026 (effective 17 March 2026) for the six metropolitan cities.

- **POSB account maintenance fee:** The fee deducted when the minimum balance of Rs. 500 is not maintained at the end of the financial year is **Rs. 50** (not Rs. 100). The minimum balance for a non-cheque account is Rs. 50; for a cheque-facility account it is Rs. 500. Interest rate is 4% p.a. (Q4 FY 2025-26).
- **Silent / Inoperative account:** An account becomes silent / inoperative after **three complete financial years** of no deposit or withdrawal. Interest does continue to be credited to such accounts.
- **Section numbers under the Post Office Act 2023:** The Act has only **11 sections** in total. References in the original notes to "Section 47" of the 2023 Act are incorrect (the corresponding provision of the 1898 Act was Section 44; under the 2023 Act this subject-matter is dealt with by Section 7 - Power to make rules - read with the Post Office Regulations 2024). These citations have been corrected.
- **Chapter numbering, Part III:** The original Part III re-uses the heading "Chapter 3" for two different chapters and re-uses a single number-series across them. This has been re-organised so that chapters are sequential (Chapter 1 to Chapter 8) and rule numbers within each chapter are unique.
- **Insurance and cash-handling limits:** Wherever the original notes carried inconsistent figures across the three parts (e.g., postman cash-bag limit, GDS cash-handling limit, postman insured-article delivery limit), the text has been reconciled and the latest position has been retained alongside the Manual text, with explicit cross-references.

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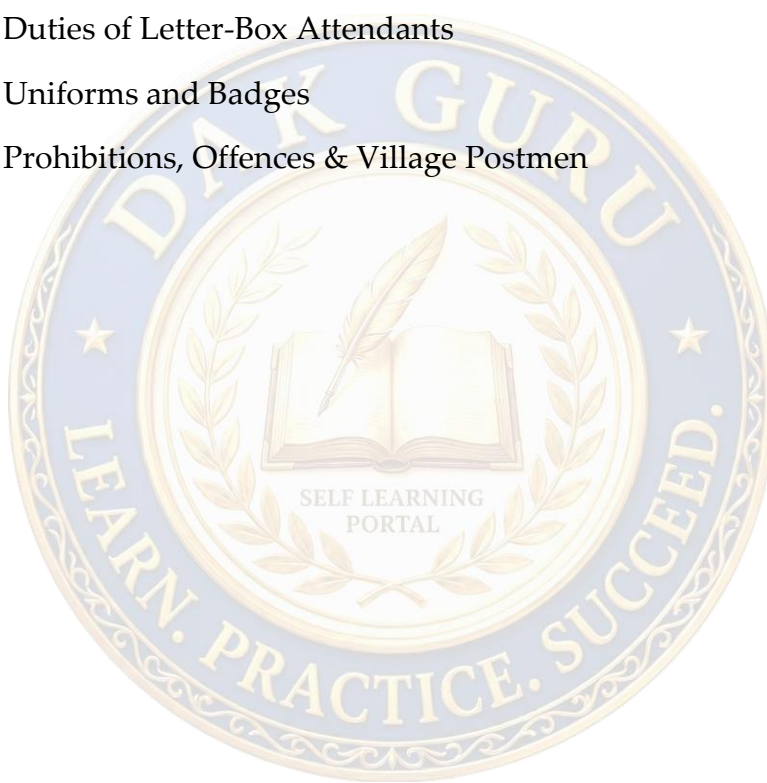
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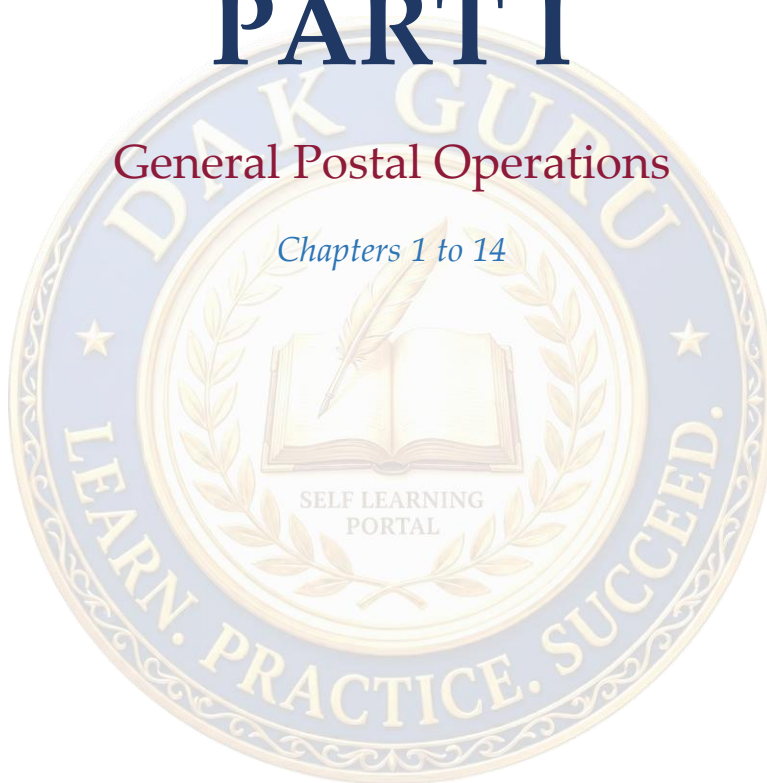
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PART I

General Postal Operations

Chapters 1 to 14



Chapter 1 — Miscellaneous Rules

Rule 1. No gratuities to be taken by officials

- The Postmaster must see that, where it can be done without interfering with office work, officials assist illiterate persons in filling up Money-Order and other postal forms; he must strictly enforce the rule prohibiting acceptance of any fee or gratuity for such assistance.
- If professional letter-writers are allowed to work on the premises, the Postmaster must see that their charges conform to the prescribed scale and report any attempt at extortion to the Superintendent. Approved candidates and relatives of clerks must not be allowed to work as professional letter-writers.

Rule 2. Work on Sundays and Post Office holidays

- Savings Bank transactions, payment of Money Orders / e-Money Orders and delivery of ordinary mail are not, by default, carried out on Sundays and Post Office holidays; other work may be performed.
- As an exception, offices required to function on Sundays prepare the daily HO / SO accounts for Sunday transactions in the usual manner.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Business hours (Post Office Regulations, 2024)

Regulation 5 of the Post Office Regulations, 2024 (notification S.O. 5440(E) dated 16 December 2024) empowers the Circle Head, Regional Head and Divisional Head to fix the business hours of every post office in their jurisdiction, including working on Sundays and holidays, and to specify the services to be offered during such hours.

Rule 2-A. Night Post Offices

- Working hours of post offices are fixed by the Head of the Circle subject to the timings in Clause 1 of the Post Office Guide. The Director-General may extend the working hours of a post office up to 8:30 P.M. and keep it open on Sundays; such offices are termed Night Post Offices.

Work normally undertaken in extended hours at Night Post Offices:

Service	Transaction limit / details
Registry items	Including V.P. items may be booked.

Service	Transaction limit / details
Money Orders	e-MO (formerly T.M.O.) may be issued.
Stamps / IPO	IPO, National Savings Certificates and postal stamps may be sold.
Savings Bank	Related work up to 7:30 P.M.
Wire money payments	Up to 6:00 P.M.

Rule 3. Departments of a Post Office

The work of a large post office is divided into the following departments:

- Mails
- Sorting
- Delivery
- Deposits
- Registration (now subsumed within Speed Post — see Rule 156)
- Parcels
- Money Orders
- Cash
- Sub-Account

Rule 4. Memorandum of Distribution of Work

- The Postmaster maintains a Memorandum of Distribution of Work in Form Ms-11, showing the duties assigned to each official. The memorandum must be kept current and signed by the Postmaster.
- In Head Offices and large Sub-Offices, the nominal roll of Postal Assistants actually on duty on any given day is maintained in Form Ms-12.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Definition of "Post"

Regulation 3 of the Post Office Regulations, 2024 defines "Post" as any system for collection, clearance, sorting, dispatch, conveyance and delivery of items by the postal network. "Item" (Section 2(b) of the Act) means an indivisible article which the Post Office accepts for providing a service.

Rule 4-A. Attendance Register

- An Attendance Register in Form S-37 is maintained in every post office having more than one clerk.

Rule 5. Village Sorting List

- A Village Sorting List in Form M-52 is prepared and supplied to each office by the Sub-Divisional Inspector.
- The list contains the names of all villages served by the office and the days on which they are served.
- A Route List in Form M-53 is issued by the Sub-Divisional Inspector to the Village Postman.

Rule 6. Yearly Village Return

- The yearly Village Return (Form Ms-88), prepared in February each year, is kept by the Sub-Account Assistant and shows the number of articles of every class received for delivery in each village within the office's jurisdiction.
- On completion, the return is totalled, signed by the Postmaster and forwarded to the Sub-Divisional Inspector.

Rule 9. Receipts to be taken from addressees

- Receipts are taken from the addressees of redirected articles in cases where the article has been opened or damaged.

Rule 10. Assessment of Customs Duty

- Assessment of customs duty on inward foreign articles is the duty of the Customs Authorities; realization of the duty is the duty of the Post Office.
- The Postmaster must ensure that the duty assessed is recovered before the article is delivered.

Rule 17. Payments in cash and notes; admittance of strangers

- Payments may be made in cash or by currency notes. The public have no right to demand change for notes.
- Strangers must not be admitted to the post office work-area; the Postmaster must enforce this strictly.

- Information received officially must not be made public; this restriction does not apply to disclosure to:
- a competent Court of Law,
- the District Magistrate, or
- the Commissioner of Police or District Superintendent of Police.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Interception powers (Section 9, Post Office Act 2023)

Section 9 of the Post Office Act, 2023 now governs interception of postal items. The Central Government may, on the occurrence of any public emergency or in the interest of public safety or tranquility, or on grounds of the security of the State, friendly relations with foreign States, public order, or for preventing incitement to the commission of any offence, empower an officer to intercept, open or detain any item.

Rule 21. Custody of blank forms

- The Postmaster is responsible for the safe custody of blank forms, especially Money-Order forms and other accountable forms.
- The MO Oblong Stamp and Insurance Stamp are kept in the personal custody of the Postmaster.

Rule 25. Disposal of Records

- Records must be preserved for the periods prescribed in the Manual.

Selected preservation periods (illustrative):

Record	Preservation period
Nominal Roll	Permanent
Stock Book	10 years
Order Book / Post Office Order Book	Permanent
Register of undeliverable passbooks in deposit at HO	Permanent (not destroyed without Head-of-Circle permission)

The following records may not be destroyed without the special permission of the Head of the Circle:

- the Post Office Order Book;
- the Register of undeliverable passbooks in deposit in the Head Office;

- correspondence regarding which an enquiry is in progress or which is connected with cases not yet fully decided.

Rule 27. Remittances

- A leather cash bag is to be used when the amount of currency notes exceeds Rs. 500.
- When a remittance is sent by post, the money is placed in a leather cash bag and cash-sealed by the Treasurer.

Cross-reference: Cash conveyance limits

The Rs. 500 figure here is the threshold for using a leather cash bag for routine remittance and is distinct from the per-official cash-conveyance ceiling, which is governed by the security-branch instructions reproduced under Rule 31 of Part III of this Manual (Single official by foot or public transport: up to Rs. 2 lakh; by departmental / hired vehicle: up to Rs. 5 lakh; two officials with armed guard: up to Rs. 25 lakh).

Rule 32-1. Identification Cards — loss

- The loss of an Identification Card must immediately be notified by the Head of the Circle through his Circular.

Rule 32-2. Business Reply Cards

- The annual fee for Business Reply Cards is realised in advance and credited to Unclassified Receipts (UCR).

Chapter 2 — Mail Department

Rule 57. Clearance of Letter Boxes

- Hours of clearance must be so fixed that mails reach the post office in time for their intended despatch.
- Letter boxes fixed in walls or pillars must be provided with movable plates showing the hours of clearance.
- The official clearing a letter box verifies that the lock is in good order, reports any defect immediately to the Postmaster, unlocks the box, empties the contents into his bag and locks the box again.
- Letter-Box Peons must carry a badge and a time-piece; while on their clearance rounds they are not allowed to distribute letters or perform other duties.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Merger of Registered Post with Speed Post (effective 01.09.2025)

Source: Department of Posts directive dated 2 July 2025 ("Merger of Registered Post with Speed Post"), effective **1 September 2025**; PIB Fact-Check clarification dated 7 August 2025.

Effect: Speed Post (Document and Parcel) is henceforth the basic mail service for address-specific delivery of accountable items. Registration continues as a **value-added service** of Speed Post (fee Rs. 5 + GST per item). The legally significant features of the erstwhile Registered Post — addressee-specific delivery, proof of delivery, acknowledgement and tracking — survive within the Speed Post framework. Documents, websites and forms previously mentioning "Registered Post" now refer exclusively to "Speed Post".

Important — PIB clarification: The service has not been discontinued; it has been merged / upgraded. Existing legal references in statutes that mention "Registered Post" therefore remain operative through Speed Post.

Rule 60. Facing

- Articles cleared from letter boxes are brought to the facing table.
- Facing means arranging articles with the address side upwards and all addresses turned in the same direction.
- While facing, articles are divided into two classes:
- Articles of the Letter Mail (letters, postcards, letter cards).
- Articles of the Packet Mail (book packets, pattern packets and registered newspapers).

Rule 61. Stamping

- All postage stamps on articles must be defaced with the date-stamp. The purpose of defacement is to prevent re-use.
- If a stamp has escaped defacement at the office of posting, it must be defaced at the office of delivery or at any intermediate office where the irregularity is noticed.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Postage deemed not prepaid

Regulation 7 of the Post Office Regulations, 2024 provides that postage shall not be deemed to be prepaid if the stamp has been obliterated, defaced, torn, cut or otherwise rendered imperfect.



Chapter 3 — Sorting Department

Rule 64. Station Bundles

- When the number of articles of the Letter Mail (excluding registered articles) for any post office or mail office exceeds 14, they are formed into a separate Station Bundle.
- The bundle is tied with a check-slip (Form M-7) facing outwards.
- When the number of articles for a State or Territory is sufficient to form a bundle but not enough for a station bundle to a single office, a Territorial Bundle may be prepared.
- Articles for which no station or territorial bundle can be formed are termed "Unsorted" and are disposed of in the Sorting Case.

Rule 65. Direct Mail Bags

- A Direct Mail Bag is a bag closed by a post office or mail office for another post office or mail office with which it is not in direct communication.
- A direct mail bag should be closed when the number of articles for a particular office exceeds 200, or when the articles are sufficiently bulky to fill a bag.
- The label must bear the letter "D" to distinguish the bag from an ordinary account or sorting bag.
- Direct mail bags must not contain registered articles or money orders unless specifically authorised.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Gyan Post (effective 01.05.2025)

Source: Post Office (Second Amendment) Regulations, 2025, notification **G.S.R. 263(E) dated 28 April 2025**, effective **1 May 2025**. Inserted as Regulation 92A in the Post Office Regulations, 2024.

Scope: Books / packets containing books (a) prescribed in syllabi by recognised boards / universities / autonomous bodies of Government, (b) of social, cultural or religious nature, or (c) text-books for competitive examinations.

Conditions:

- must bear the inscription "**Gyan Post**" on the outside;
- must not contain any advertisements other than incidental announcements or book lists;
- each book must show the name of the printer or publisher;
- commercial or business books are not eligible;
- periodicals (magazines, journals issued at regular intervals) are not eligible;

- **minimum weight:** 300 grams; **maximum weight:** 5 kg;
- **transmission:** surface mode only;
- **tracking:** compulsory (trackable item);
- **tariff:** Rs. 20 (minimum, up to 300 g) to Rs. 100 (maximum, up to 5 kg), plus applicable GST;
- registration, proof of delivery and insurance are available as value-added services on payment of the prescribed fees.

Rule 83. Sorting Cases

- The sorting case is divided into pigeon-holes, each labelled with the name of a post office, mail office or section. Labels are arranged geographically to facilitate sorting.
- The Postmaster must ensure that the sorting case used corresponds to the sorting list supplied by the Superintendent.
- The sorting case must be examined daily to ensure that no article is left in the pigeon-holes after the despatch of mails.

Rule 85. Missent Articles

- Missent articles are articles erroneously forwarded to an office other than the office of destination or the proper office of transit.
- Such articles must be stamped "Missent" and forwarded to their correct destination by the first available mail.
- A report of missent articles must be made to the Superintendent in Form Ms-14 (Error Book).

Chapter 4 — Delivery of Mails

Rule 98. Limitation of Delivery

- Delivery of articles is limited to the hours fixed by the Head of the Circle.
- No person living within the limits of the post town is entitled to receive his letters at the window of the post office unless he rents a Post Box, or unless the article is one that cannot be delivered through postmen.

STATUTORY UPDATE — OTP-based delivery (Speed Post)

Source: Post Office (Fourth Amendment) Regulations, 2025, notification **S.O. 4375(E) dated 25 September 2025**.

Salient features:

- OTP-based delivery is offered as a **value-added service** for Speed Post Documents and Parcels;
- **fee:** Rs. 5 + GST per item (in addition to regular postage);
- the item is handed over to the addressee only after successful confirmation of the OTP shared with the delivery staff;
- **Cross-reference:** Post Office (Second Amendment) Regulations, 2026 (notification **S.O. 1329(E) dated 13 March 2026**, effective 17 March 2026) introduced "24 Speed Post Parcel" between Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai, Kolkata, Bengaluru and Hyderabad, in which OTP-based delivery is provided **free of charge** as a bundled service.

Rule 113. Window Delivery

- "Window Delivery" means delivery at the window of the post office to addressees or their authorised agents.

Articles delivered at the window include:

- articles addressed to "Poste Restante" or "To await arrival";
- articles bearing the superscription "To be kept till called for";
- articles for persons who have rented a Post Box;
- insured articles, V.P. articles and Money Orders exceeding the limit entrusted to a postman.

- The Postmaster must satisfy himself as to the identity of the person applying; if the person is not known, he must be identified by a person known to the Postmaster or must produce satisfactory evidence of identity.

Rule 114. Delivery of Registered (now "accountable Speed Post") Articles

- Registered / accountable Speed Post articles must be delivered to the addressee or his authorised agent.
- No such article may be delivered unless the addressee or his agent signs the receipt and the acknowledgement (where applicable).

STATUTORY UPDATE — Addressee-specific vs. address-specific delivery

Regulation 18, Post Office Regulations 2024:

- **Addressee-specific delivery:** where the sender has opted for this value-added service (fee Rs. 5 + GST), the item is delivered exclusively to the addressee or to a person specifically authorised by the addressee.
- **Address-specific delivery:** in other cases, delivery may be made to any adult member of the family at the address, provided the addressee has not lodged a specific objection.

Rule 115. Post Boxes

- The Post Box system enables regular recipients to obtain their letters at the earliest possible moment.

Conditions:

- a Post Box may be rented at any post office where the system is in force;
- the renter is supplied with a key;
- articles addressed to the Post Box number are placed in the box;
- the renter or his messenger may clear the box at any time during business hours.

Prescribed rents (Manual rate):

Period	Rent (Manual rate)
Full financial year (April–March)	Rs. 150
Three calendar months	Rs. 50

🔔 STATUTORY UPDATE — Post Boxes under Regulations 46 & 47, PO Regulations 2024

Items not capable of being placed in the box: where any item addressed to a Post Box number cannot, in view of its size or nature (e.g., parcels, registered / accountable articles), be placed in the box, an intimation slip is placed in the box [Regulation 46(c)(i)].

Withdrawal of facility: the Postmaster may withdraw the Post Box facility if the renter fails to clear the box for 7 days despite notice [Regulation 47].

Rule 120. Intimation of Arrival

- When a registered / accountable, insured or value-payable article cannot be delivered by the postman (addressee absent, large amount, etc.), an Intimation in Form Rp-53 is delivered to the addressee.
- The article is retained in the post office for 7 days (excluding the day of presentation).
- If the addressee fails to take delivery within this period, the article is returned to the sender.

🔔 STATUTORY UPDATE — Digital intimation and extended retention

Source: India Post Parcel Regulations, 2024 (Administrative Instructions).

- **Digital intimation:** for trackable items (Speed Post / Parcels) intimation may be sent by SMS to the mobile number on record.
- **Retention:** undelivered parcels are retained for 7 days after the first delivery attempt.
- **Extension:** the addressee may request retention for up to 7 additional days in writing (maximum total 14 days).

Rule 134. Refusal of Articles

- If the addressee refuses to accept an article, it is marked "Refused" and returned to the sender immediately.
- The postman's statement of refusal is to be accepted as correct unless there is evidence to the contrary.
- An addressee cannot accept the article while refusing to pay customs duty or other charges; he must either accept it with all charges or refuse it entirely.

Chapter 5 — Deposit Department

Rule 137. Articles addressed to deceased persons

- An article addressed to a deceased person is treated as unclaimed and disposed of accordingly, unless there is no doubt as to the title of the claimant to receive it.
- Where the title is clear (e.g., a near relative who has taken charge of the deceased's property), the Postmaster may deliver the article to that person on his granting a receipt and indemnifying the Post Office against future claims.
- In case of any dispute or doubt, the article is returned to the sender or to the Returned Letter Office (RLO) with the remark "Deceased".
- Insured or value-payable articles addressed to a deceased person must not be delivered without the specific orders of the Head of the Circle or other competent authority, unless the claimant produces a legal succession certificate.

Rule 138. Detention of articles in the Post Office

- Ordinary articles of the Letter Mail (unregistered) which cannot be delivered are not detained for more than 7 days.
- Station articles (addressed within the post town) which are unclaimed are returned to the RLO after 7 days.

Exceptions:

- articles addressed to persons temporarily absent may be kept for a period not exceeding 7 days, provided the Postmaster has reason to believe they will return;
- "Poste Restante" articles are kept for one month.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Standardised retention period

Regulation 43, Post Office Regulations 2024: the retention period for all categories of undeliverable mail (accountable / Speed Post / Parcel) where the addressee is not found is standardised to **7 days** from the date of the last delivery attempt. If the addressee refuses the article, it must be returned immediately (no detention).

Chapter 6 — Registration Department

⚠ Status of Registration (Important — read first)

With effect from 1 September 2025, the standalone Registered Post service has been merged with Speed Post. Registration now operates as a value-added feature of Speed Post (fee Rs. 5 + GST). The rules in this chapter continue to apply mutatis mutandis to accountable Speed Post items; references to "registered articles" should be read accordingly. The legal validity, person-specific delivery and acknowledgement features of the former Registered Post survive within the Speed Post framework (PIB Fact-Check, 7 August 2025).

Rule 156. General Rules (Registration / Accountable Speed Post)

Registration is compulsory for:

- any parcel exceeding 4 kilograms in weight;
- any insured article;
- any article containing a cheque, hundi, banknote or postage stamps;
- any article bearing the word "Registered" on the cover.
- The registration fee must be prepaid in addition to the postage.

Rule 163. Preparation of Registered Bundles

- When the number of registered / accountable articles for despatch to any office or section exceeds 2, they are formed into a Registered Bundle.
- A Registered List (Form Rp-32) is placed inside the bundle.
- The bundle is tied with a special knot (reef knot) and sealed with the registration seal.
- If the number of registered articles is large or bulky, they are enclosed in a Blue Registered Bag (symbol "R").

Rule 170. Compensation for loss or damage

- The Director-General may grant compensation to the sender of a registered / accountable article lost or damaged in transmission by post.

Conditions:

- the application for compensation must be made within 3 months of the date of posting;

- compensation is not payable if the loss is due to the fault or negligence of the sender (e.g., insecure packing).

Exclusions — no compensation is payable for:

- loss of currency notes (unless insured);
- damage to fragile articles not properly packed.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Current compensation limits

Sources: Department of Posts compensation schedule (see Lok Sabha Unstarred Question 2718 and Schedule I, Table V of the PO Regulations 2024 read with subsequent amendments).

Product	Compensation limit
Speed Post (Document / Parcel, including erstwhile Registered)	Double the Speed Post charges or Rs. 1,000, whichever is less
International Registered (UPU)	30 SDR (Special Drawing Rights)
Business Parcel	Rs. 500 or the actual value, whichever is less

Rule 174. Delivery to illiterate addressees

- If a registered / accountable article is delivered to an illiterate addressee, his thumb-impression or other mark is taken on the receipt and acknowledgement.
- The mark is attested by a respectable witness (other than the postman) who is personally known to the postman or the Postmaster.

Chapter 7 — Parcel Department

Rule 179. Examination of Parcels

- Parcels received for despatch are examined to ensure secure packing and compliance with the conditions of posting.
- If a parcel is not securely packed, or is packed contrary to the rules (e.g., containing prohibited liquids or sharp instruments), it must not be accepted for transmission.
- Every parcel must be weighed. If the weight exceeds the prescribed limit (20 kilograms for ordinary / accountable parcels), it must be returned to the sender.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Standardisation and volumetric weight

Source: India Post Parcel Network Policy (Administrative Instructions under the PO Regulations 2024).

- **Maximum length:** 1.5 metres.
- **Maximum length + girth:** 3 metres.
- **Volumetric weight:** for light but bulky parcels, postage is charged on the volumetric weight, calculated as $L \times W \times H \div 5000$ (dimensions in cm, result in kg).

Rule 185. Transmission of Parcels

- Parcels are transmitted by surface mail unless the sender has paid the fee for air transmission.
- Parcels weighing more than 4 kilograms must be registered (now: booked as accountable Speed Post).
- Parcels must be handled with care; they must not be thrown or dragged.

Rule 193. Redirected Parcels

- A parcel redirected to any place served by the Inland Post is chargeable with a redirection fee.
- The redirection fee is half the prepaid postage.
- No redirection fee is charged if the revised address is within the same delivery area or post town.
- If the addressee refuses to pay the redirection fee, the parcel is not delivered but treated as refused.

🔔 STATUTORY UPDATE — Redirection charges (Regulation 51)

- **Speed Post Parcels:** no redirection fee if the new address is within the same city / district; for inter-city redirection, the full tariff applies.
- **Business Parcels:** redirection is chargeable at the full tariff for the new leg of transmission.



Chapter 8 — Insured Articles

Rule 196. Responsibility of the Post Office

- The Post Office is responsible for the loss of the postal article or any of its contents, or for any damage caused to it in transmission by post, provided that the article has been insured and the prescribed insurance fee has been paid.

Exceptions — the Post Office is not responsible:

- if the loss or damage is caused by the fault or negligence of the sender (e.g., defective packing);
- if the article contains prohibited goods;
- in cases of force majeure (e.g., earthquake, war);
- if the claim is not made within 3 months.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Limitation of Government liability

Section 10, Post Office Act 2023: the Government incurs liability only where expressly provided for in the Act or in the regulations, and only in accordance with the prescribed conditions. There is no general right of action against the Government for loss, mis-delivery or delay of any item; insurance remains the principal route by which a sender may obtain compensation for loss.

Rule 200. Examination of Insured Articles (Conditions)

- Every article tendered for insurance is examined to ensure that it is securely packed and sealed.
- The seals must be distinct and must be impressions of the same private seal of the sender. The seal device must not be that of a current coin or merely a series of straight, curved or crossed lines.
- The envelope must be strong, non-transparent and must have no black or coloured border.
- The weight (in grams) and the insured value (in words and figures) must be noted on the face of the article.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Insurance limits (Financial Services Division, 2024–25)

- **Maximum insurance limit:** up to Rs. 10,00,000 (Ten Lakh) for Speed Post articles at authorised Head Offices.

- **Branch Post Offices:** limit for booking insured articles remains Rs. 600.
- **Currency notes by Insured Post:** transmission of currency notes is limited to Rs. 20,000.

Rule 203. Delivery of Insured Articles

- An insured article may be delivered by the postman if the value insured does not exceed Rs. 500 (the Manual figure used for examination purposes).
- If the value exceeds Rs. 500, or if the article is damaged or tampered with, it must be delivered at the window of the post office.
- In such cases an intimation in Form Rp-53 is sent to the addressee.
- The addressee must sign the receipt and acknowledgement. If the article is damaged, delivery is made in the presence of the Postmaster and a note of the contents and damage is recorded in the Error Book.

Exam tip

The departmental Manual continues to test the Rs. 500 doorstep-delivery limit. In operational practice, the postman's cash-handling / doorstep delivery limit is much higher under current SB Orders (e.g., enhanced limits for AePS / IPPB transactions) — but for paper-based Vol. VI Part I questions, use Rs. 500 unless the question expressly asks for the "current ruling".

Chapter 9 — Money Order Department

Rule 236. Issue of Money Orders

- Money Orders are issued on the prescribed form (M.O. 8). The remitter must fill in the entries in ink.

Prohibitions:

- no Money Order may contain any fractional part of a paisa;
- the amount of a single Money Order must not exceed Rs. 5,000.
- The remitter may write a communication to the payee on the coupon portion of the Money-Order form; this portion is detached and given to the payee at the time of payment.

STATUTORY UPDATE — eMO and iMO (current position)

Source: Financial Services Division, Department of Posts.

- **Standardisation:** all Inland Money Orders are now transmitted electronically as eMOs.
- **eMO maximum limit:** Rs. 5,000 per Money Order.
- **iMO (Instant Money Order):** web-based service available between authorised iMO centres for amounts from Rs. 1,000 to Rs. 50,000.
- **iMO commission (indicative):** Rs. 1,000–10,000: Rs. 100; Rs. 10,001–30,000: Rs. 110; Rs. 30,001–50,000: Rs. 120.

Note: Earlier study material had suggested the single-MO ceiling had been raised to Rs. 10,000. No published Gazette notification supports that figure; the operative ceiling for a single eMO remains Rs. 5,000.

Rule 245. Alteration of Payee's Name or Address

The remitter of a Money Order which has not been paid may require:

- that the address of the payee be altered;
- that the name of the payee be altered;
- that the Money Order be stopped and the money repaid to him.

No additional fee is charged where:

- the alteration is only in the address of the payee (within India);
- the money is to be repaid to the remitter.

- If the name of the payee is to be changed to that of another person, a second commission (equal to the first) is payable by the remitter.
- The remitter applies in writing to the Postmaster of the office of issue and encloses the Money-Order receipt.

Rule 268. Payment of Money Orders

- Money Orders are paid by the postman at the address of the payee.

Limits for the postman:

- aggregate Money-Order value taken out for payment at one time: Rs. 5,000 (or the limit fixed by the Circle Head);
- single-Money-Order cash-payment limit: Rs. 5,000.
- The postman must satisfy himself as to the identity of the payee; if the payee is not known, identification by a respectable known person is required.
- The payee must sign the Money Order and acknowledgement in ink; thumb-impressions must be attested.

Rule 275. Unpaid Money Orders

- If the payee cannot be found or refuses payment, the Money Order is returned to the office of issue for repayment to the remitter.
- If payment is refused, the word "Refused" is written across the Money Order.

Rule 276. Void Money Orders

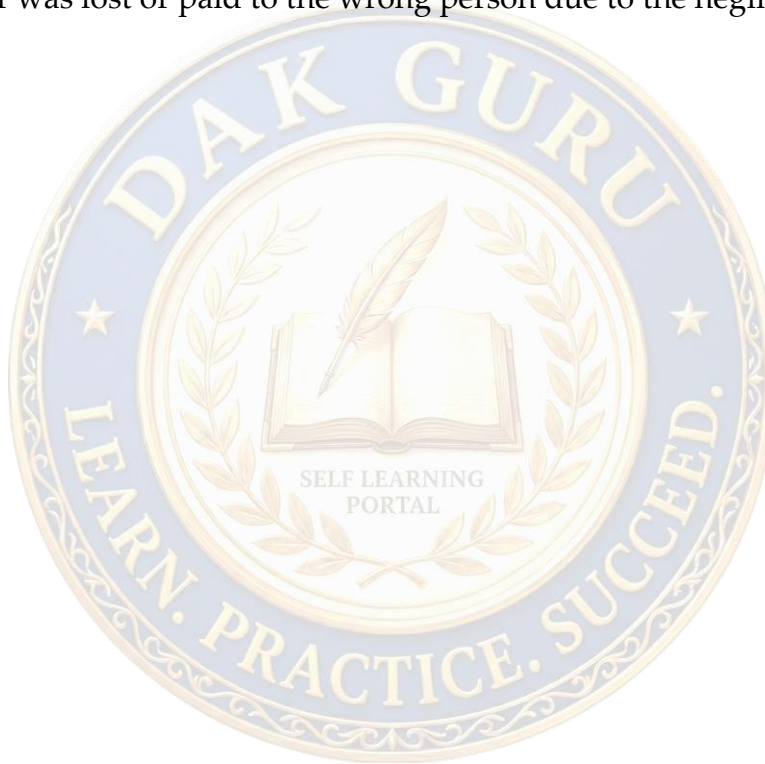
- Period of currency: a Money Order remains current for one month following the month of issue.
- If a Money Order is not paid to the payee or repaid to the remitter before the expiration of the last day of the month following the month of issue, it becomes a Void Money Order.
- A Void Money Order cannot be paid without the special sanction of the Head of the Circle (or competent authority delegated by him).
- If the claim for the amount of a Void Money Order is not preferred within one year from the date of issue, the amount is forfeited to the Government.

 **STATUTORY UPDATE — Digital tracking under APT 2.0**

While eMOs are tracked digitally end-to-end, the statutory "void" status remains tied to the accounting cycle described above. In the APT 2.0 environment, unclaimed amounts are automatically classified as "Void MO" in the system after the prescribed period.

Rule 281. Loss of Money Order

- If a Money Order is lost in transit, a duplicate Money Order may be issued.
- The remitter or payee may apply for an inquiry. If the Money Order has not been paid, a duplicate is issued free of charge.
- The Post Office is responsible for the amount of the Money Order if it is proved that the Money Order was lost or paid to the wrong person due to the negligence of postal staff.



Chapter 10 — Value Payable (V.P.) Articles

Rule 290. General Rules

- Registered parcels, registered letters, registered book-packets and registered newspapers (with or without registration) may be transmitted by Inland Post as Value Payable articles.
- The sender declares the amount to be recovered from the addressee — the "Value Payable" amount.
- The amount specified for recovery must not exceed Rs. 5,000.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Cash-on-Delivery (COD) Facility

For bulk / contractual customers, the V.P. system has largely been replaced by the COD facility linked to Speed Post / Business Parcel.

- **Maximum COD limit:** Rs. 50,000 per article.
- **Remittance to sender:** directly into the sender's bank account via ECS / NEFT, in place of the traditional V.P. Money-Order route.

Rule 296. Detention of V.P. Articles

- If the addressee is not found or the article cannot be delivered, an intimation in Form Rp-53 is served.
- The article is retained for 7 days from the date of first presentation or the date of delivery of the intimation.
- On written request of the addressee, the article may be detained for a further period not exceeding 7 days (total 14 days).
- For the extra detention (days 8 to 14) a Warehousing Charge (Demurrage) is recovered from the addressee at the time of delivery.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Warehousing charges (Post Office Guide, Part I, Clause 55)

- **V.P. Letters / Packets:** Rs. 3.00 per day.
- **V.P. Parcels:** Rs. 5.00 per day.
- **Exemption:** no charge is levied if the post office is closed, or if the delay is due to the fault of the service.

Rule 298. Procedure when V.P. is Refused

- If the addressee refuses the article or refuses to pay the amount due, the article is returned to the sender immediately — it is not detained.
- If the addressee fails to take delivery after the prescribed detention period (7 days, or 14 days where extension was granted), the article is treated as unclaimed and returned to the sender.



Chapter 11 — Official Postal Articles

Rule 305. Official Postal Articles

- Official postal articles must bear the superscription "On India Government Service" (O.I.G.S.) or "On Service" when posted by authorised government officials.
- They must bear Service Postage Stamps (overprinted "SERVICE"). Ordinary postage stamps should not be used on official correspondence unless service stamps are unavailable.
- The official's signature and designation must be entered in the lower left-hand corner of the article (or on the frank).

STATUTORY UPDATE — Restriction on Service Stamps

- Service Stamps are strictly for the use of Government Offices only.
- **Use by public:** possession or use of Service Stamps by private individuals or unauthorised bodies is prohibited and punishable under the Post Office Act.
- **Phase-out:** Government departments are being encouraged to migrate to Franking Machines or pre-payment accounts to reduce the printing of physical Service stamps.

Rule 309. Unpaid Official Articles

- Official articles which are unpaid or insufficiently paid are not taxed with the usual double-deficiency penalty.
- They are charged with the single deficiency (actual amount due) only.
- The rule requiring prepayment of postage on parcels does not apply strictly to official parcels; however, postage should generally be prepaid.

Rule 312. Camp Articles

- Articles addressed to officers of Government "in Camp" (e.g., "Camp Bag") are delivered without claim for any redirection fee, provided the officer is entitled to the privilege.
- This privilege is restricted to high-ranking officers (e.g., the President, the Prime Minister, the Director-General of Posts) listed in the "Camp List" issued by the Director-General.
- Special bags containing official mail for such officers are termed "Camp Bags".

Chapter 12 — Identification Cards

Rule 317. System of Identification Cards

- The Identification Card system enables strangers to establish their identity when applying for delivery of registered or insured articles or for payment of Money Orders.
- Any respectable, literate person who can sign his name may apply to the Head Postmaster for an Identification Card.
- The application is accompanied by the prescribed fee and a passport-size photograph of the applicant.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Current fee structure

- **Fee:** Rs. 100 (subject to periodic revision).
- **Validity:** 3 years from the date of issue.

Note: With the implementation of Aadhaar-based biometric authentication for many postal services, the physical Identification Card system is less frequently used, but remains a valid statutory provision.

Rule 319. Particulars of the Card

- The card contains a full description of the holder, his signature and his photograph.
- Validity: 3 years from the date of issue.
- On applying for a postal transaction, the holder produces the card; the postal official compares the signature and photograph on the card with the person and the signature on the receipt.

Chapter 13 — Franking Machines

Rule 322. Licensing of Franking Machines

- The Director-General may authorise the use of franking machines by government offices, commercial firms and private individuals for prepayment of postage.
- No machine may be used without a Licence issued by the Head of the Postal Division (Superintendent of Post Offices).
- The machine must be of a type and pattern approved by the Director-General.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Mandatory migration to RMFM

- All Electronic Franking Machines (EFMs) of older technology have been phased out.
- **Only Remotely Managed Franking Machines (RMFM)** (Digi-Franking) are permitted for new licences and renewals.
- **RMFM features:** such machines download funds remotely via a secure server (Credifon) and do not require physical travel to the post office for resetting.

Rule 324. Conditions of Use

- The franking-machine impression must be in bright-red ink and must show the value of postage, the name of the office of posting and the date.
- The user may print a slogan or advertisement alongside the frank impression, provided the design has been approved by the Licensing Authority.
- The user must maintain a "Daily Docket" or usage register showing the meter readings before and after use each day.

Rule 328. Posting of Franked Articles

- Franked articles must be tendered at the counter of the specific post office designated in the licence.
- Articles must be bundled according to the value of the frank (all Rs. 5 articles in one bundle, etc.).
- There is no limit to the number of articles that can be posted, but they must be presented within the business hours fixed for the purpose.
- Franked articles must not be posted in letter boxes; if found in a letter box, they are treated as unpaid.

Rule 329. Rebate on Franking-Machine Usage

- A rebate is granted on the total value of postage consumed during the previous month.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Rebate structure (RMFM users, 2025)

Minimum consumption	Rebate rate
Up to Rs. 5,000	Nil
Rs. 5,001 and above	3% on the entire amount

Conditions: articles must be sorted PIN-code wise (or as per Sorting District) and bundled correctly; the rebate is credited to the franking-machine account at the time of the next resetting / upload.

Rule 330. Resetting of the Machine

- For manual / older electronic machines, the machine is brought to the post office for resetting (loading of funds) when the credit is exhausted; the window clerk checks the meter readings, collects the payment and resets the meter in the presence of the user.
- For RMFM, physical movement of the machine is not required: the user deposits money in the designated bank / post office account and the credit is downloaded via the modem / internet connection.

Rule 334. Repairs and Withdrawal

- If a machine becomes defective, the user must immediately stop using it and report the matter to the post office.
- Repairs may be carried out only by the authorised agents of the manufacturing company. Breaking the Post Office seal by unauthorised persons is strictly prohibited.
- If the licence is cancelled or the user wishes to discontinue, the machine is surrendered to the post office for removal of the die / cancellation of the licence.

Chapter 14 — Post Office Savings Bank (Administrative Rules)

Rule 340. General Responsibility

- The Postmaster is responsible for the correct maintenance of Savings Bank accounts and for the safe custody of passbooks and other documents connected with them.
- Officers of the Postal Department are prohibited from disclosing the name of any depositor, or the amount deposited or withdrawn, except to the depositor himself or to officers of the Department concerned with the Savings Bank work.

Information may be disclosed to:

- a Court of Law;
- Income-Tax Authorities (under specific statutory provisions).

STATUTORY UPDATE — Secrecy and disclosure

Government Savings Promotion General Rules, 2018 (as amended, 2024) — Rule 13:

- **Financial Intelligence Unit (FIU-IND):** data on high-value transactions is shared for AML/CFT compliance.
- **Income-Tax Department (SFT — Statement of Financial Transactions):** cash deposits exceeding Rs. 10 lakh in a financial year are reported.

Rule 343. Application for Opening an Account

- Any person wishing to open an account fills in the application form (Form SB-3).
- The applicant must be introduced by a respectable person known to the Postmaster, or by a depositor having an account in the same post office.
- The Postmaster must ensure that the address and identity of the depositor are verified.

STATUTORY UPDATE — KYC (SB Order on KYC Master Circular)

- **Aadhaar Number and PAN** are mandatory for opening any new account.
- If PAN is not submitted at the time of opening, it must be submitted within 6 months, failing which the account is frozen.
- A recent photograph is mandatory for all depositors.

Rule 345. Passbooks

- A passbook (Form SB-5) is supplied free of charge at the time of opening the account.
- The passbook must be presented at the time of every deposit or withdrawal.
- The passbook remains in the custody of the depositor; it is not retained at the post office except for the entry of interest or for examination by the Inspecting Officer.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Core Banking Solution (CBS)

- **System-generated passbooks:** manual entries in passbooks are discontinued in CBS offices; all entries must be printed using the Passbook Printer.
- **Non-Home Branch:** the depositor may present the passbook at any CBS Post Office in India for deposit / withdrawal (subject to the prescribed limits).

Rule 350. Deposits and Withdrawals

- Minimum first deposit (ordinary Savings Account): Rs. 500.
- Deposits may be made by cheque; credit is given only on the date of realisation of the cheque.
- The depositor presents the passbook and a withdrawal form (Form SB-7) signed by him.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Current transaction limits (SB Orders, FY 2025-26)

Item	Current position
Minimum balance	Rs. 500 (with cheque facility); Rs. 50 (without cheque facility)
Account maintenance fee (if minimum balance not maintained for one financial year)	Rs. 50 (deducted as account maintenance charge)
Interest rate (Q4 FY 2025-26)	4.0% per annum
Maximum balance	No upper limit for single / joint accounts
Cash withdrawal at counter (without supervisory sanction)	Up to Rs. 20,000 (Counter PA limit)
ATM cash withdrawal — daily limit	Rs. 25,000 per day
Withdrawal at GDS (Branch Office) — per customer	Up to Rs. 20,000

Note: Earlier study material had stated the account maintenance fee as Rs. 100. The correct figure under the Government Savings Promotion General Rules is **Rs. 50**.

Rule 365. Silent / Inoperative Accounts

- An account in which no deposit or withdrawal has taken place for three complete financial years is treated as a Silent Account.
- No transaction is permitted in a silent account until it is revived by the Postmaster after a fresh application and KYC documents are obtained from the depositor.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Terminology and interest

- **Terminology:** "Silent Accounts" are now officially termed **Inoperative Accounts**.
- **Period:** 3 financial years of inactivity.
- **Interest:** interest continues to be credited to Inoperative Accounts (unlike the earlier rule, under which interest stopped).

Rule 370. Settlement of Deceased Claims

- On the death of a depositor, the amount standing to his credit may be paid to his nominee or legal heir.
- If a valid nomination exists (registered in the post-office records), the amount is paid to the nominee.
- Where there is no nomination, claims up to the prescribed limit may be settled by the competent authority (Postmaster / Superintendent) on the basis of a claim form and an indemnity bond.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Sanction limits for deceased claims (SB Order)

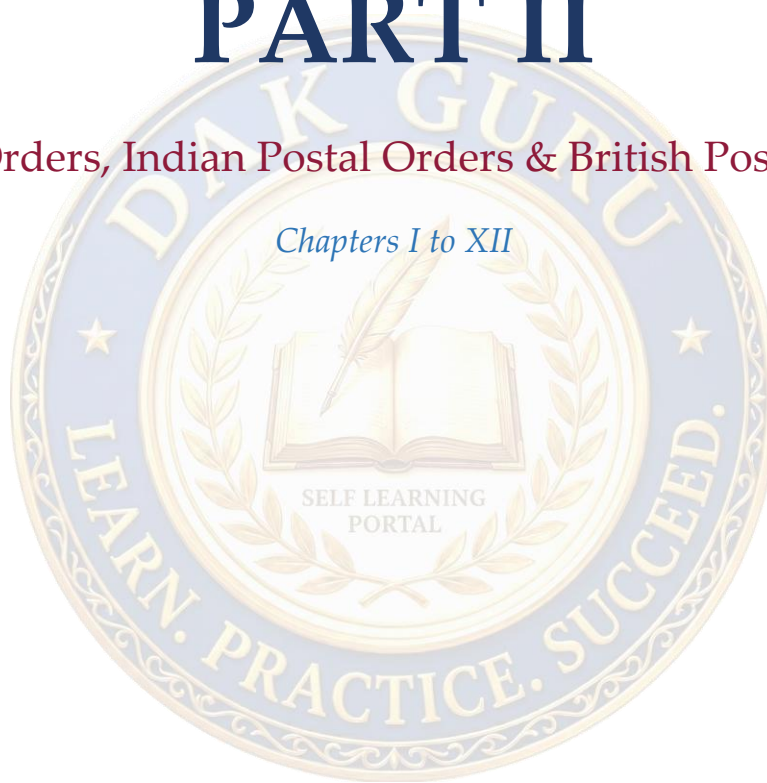
Authority	Limit (no-nomination cases)
Sub-Postmaster	Up to Rs. 50,000
Head Postmaster	Up to Rs. 5,00,000
Superintendent	Up to Rs. 10,00,000
Regional / Circle Head	Above Rs. 10,00,000

Note: For claims with a valid nomination, the Postmaster of the office where the account stands can settle the claim irrespective of the amount.

PART II

Money Orders, Indian Postal Orders & British Postal Orders

Chapters I to XII



Introductory Legal Note (Part II)

⚠ Read first — current statutory framework

Part II of the Manual operates today within the framework of the Post Office Act, 2023 (in force from 18 June 2024) and the Post Office Regulations, 2024 (notification S.O. 5440(E) dated 16 December 2024), as amended by the Post Office (Second through Seventh Amendment) Regulations, 2025 and the Post Office (First and Second Amendment) Regulations, 2026.

Where the original Manual text is overridden by current law, a STATUTORY UPDATE block follows the relevant rule. Where the original Manual text remains operative, no update is shown.



Chapter I — Issue of Inland Money Orders

Rules 1 – 7. Introductory Matters

These rules describe the constitution and general framework of the Money Order system. They are largely procedural and have been carried into the eMO / iMO regime under the Post Office Regulations, 2024.

Rule 8. Presentation of Money Order

- The remitter of a Money Order must fill in, in ink, on a Money-Order form (M.O. 8) the necessary entries, adding his signature at the foot.
- The remitter may write any communication he desires to the payee on the coupon.
- The Money-Order form, together with the amount of the order and the commission payable thereon, must be presented at the window of the post office during the hours prescribed for Money-Order business.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Digital integration

Source: Post Office Regulations, 2024 (Schedule I) and Department of Posts IT-Handbook 2024-25.

- **Single Money Order maximum:** Rs. 5,000 (eMO).
- **Form M.O. 8 retained:** the physical form continues to be valid, but the data is immediately digitised into the APT 2.0 module at the point of booking.

Note on earlier claim: Some study material had circulated a figure of Rs. 10,000 as the new single-MO ceiling. This figure is not supported by any Gazette notification and has been corrected.

Rule 9. Money Orders written in regional language

- When a Money-Order form is filled in a regional language not known at the office of issue, the Postmaster or the Money-Order Assistant must transcribe the particulars in English on the form before it is issued.
- If the remitter is unable to write, he must make his mark on the form in the presence of a witness who must sign the form and add his address.
- The witness should be known to the post-office staff; otherwise the remitter must be identified by a person known to the post office.

Rule 10. Presentation of special forms of Money Order

- Money-Order forms printed by private arrangement (e.g., for lotteries, large commercial firms) may be accepted, provided they conform strictly to the standard M.O. 8 form in size, colour and arrangement of printed matter.
- Family Allotment Money Orders are remitted by Defence Authorities; the special conditions applicable are laid down in the Defence Services Regulations.

Rule 11. Realisation of Amount

- The amount of the Money Order and the commission must be paid in cash or by cheque (subject to the conditions in Rule 46).
- Postage stamps cannot be accepted in payment of the amount of a Money Order or the commission.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Postage stamps not valid for MO payment

Regulation 9(2), Post Office Regulations 2024: consistent with modern financial rules, postage stamps (used or otherwise) are strictly invalid for paying Money-Order commission or value. Only cash, cheque or authorised digital payment modes are accepted.

Rule 12. Receipt to be given to the remitter

- The Money-Order Assistant gives the remitter a receipt (Form M.O. 1) for the amount of the order and the commission.
- The remitter should ensure that the receipt bears the date-stamp of the office and the signature of the Assistant.
- The receipt should be preserved by the remitter until he receives confirmation that the Money Order has been paid.

Rule 13. Money Orders presented in large number

- Where a large number of Money Orders are presented for issue by a single remitter, he may be required to present them at the opening of the office or at such other time as the Postmaster may fix.
- A list showing the names and addresses of payees and the amounts of the orders must be presented in duplicate with the Money Orders.

Rule 14. Money Orders from Treasuries

- Money Orders drawn by Treasury Officers are issued on Service Money-Order forms; these are exempt from commission.
- The words "On Service" must be written or stamped on the form.

Data Schedule — Money Order Limits & Fees

Service			Statutory limit	Commission / fee
Single	Money	Order	Rs. 5,000	Tariff per Schedule of Postal Rates
(eMO)				
Instant	Money	Order	Rs. 1,000 – Rs. 50,000	Tiered (Rs. 100 / Rs. 110 / Rs. 120)
(iMO)				
Service MO (Treasury)			As per Defence / Treasury rules	Commission-exempt

(Tariff rates are subject to the latest "Schedule of Postal Rates" notification.)



Chapter II — Despatch of Inland Money Orders

Operational context

Rules 19–33 describe the traditional manual process of checking and despatching Money-Order forms. In the APT 2.0 environment, despatch is instantaneous on booking: physical forms (M.O. 8) are retained at the booking office (except for specific audits) and the data is transmitted electronically. The principles of examination and responsibility, however, remain valid for departmental examinations.

Rule 19. Check of Money Orders

- The Money-Order Assistant examines the Money Orders to see that they are correctly filled in and that the amounts of commission have been correctly calculated.
- He then impresses the date-stamp of the office on the Money Orders and the receipts.
- The Assistant's signature on the receipt (M.O. 1) is a guarantee that the amount of the order and commission has been brought to account.

Rule 21. Examination by Postmaster

- The Postmaster examines the Money Orders and the Journal of Money Orders issued to see that the entries in the list agree with the Money Orders.
- He verifies that the total amount of the Money Orders and commission has been correctly entered in the accounts.
- He then signs the Money Orders and the Journal.
- In Head Offices, the Postmaster may delegate this duty to a designated Supervisor or Deputy Postmaster, but the ultimate responsibility remains his.

Rule 23. Despatch of Money Orders

- Money Orders are sorted according to offices of payment or offices of exchange, and entered in the Money-Order Check List (M.O. 70) or the Registered List.
- They are despatched to the office of payment or sorting office in the manner prescribed for registered articles.

STATUTORY UPDATE — eMO transmission

- Under the eMO (Electronic Money Order) system, despatch is electronic.

- Once the counter PA commits the transaction in the Point-of-Sale (POS) module, the MO is effectively despatched to the central server.
- The destination office (SO or HO) downloads the eMO data for payment. Physical M.O. forms do not travel to the destination; they are preserved at the booking office.



Chapter III — Payment of Money Orders

Academic note

Procedural mechanics (witnessing, identification, attestation) remain largely consistent with the Manual text. Statutory limits (amounts, validity periods) have been updated by the Post Office Regulations, 2024 under the Post Office Act, 2023.

Rule 34. Payment of Money Orders

- A Money Order must be paid to the payee named in it, or to a person authorised in writing by the payee.
- The signature of the payee or his authorised agent must be obtained on the Money Order and on the acknowledgement.
- Payment is made at the address of the payee.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Operating limits

- **Maximum remittance limit (eMO):** Rs. 5,000 per Money Order.
- **Cash-payment mode:** amounts exceeding the cash limit prescribed for a specific delivery jurisdiction may be paid by cheque or credited directly to the payee's Post Office Savings Bank (POSB) account.

Note: Earlier study material had stated the limit had been raised to Rs. 10,000 — that figure is incorrect; the current ceiling is Rs. 5,000.

Rule 35. Identification of payee

- If the payee is not known to the postman or paying officer, he must be identified by a person known to the postman or such officer.
- The identifier signs the Money Order in the space provided and adds his address.

Rule 36. Payment to illiterate payees

- If the payee is unable to write, he must produce a witness to attest his mark or thumb-impression on the Money Order and acknowledgement.
- The witness signs the Money Order and the acknowledgement and adds his address.
- The witness should be known to the postman or paying officer; otherwise the witness himself must be identified.
- The postman or other officer paying the Money Order cannot act as the witness.

Rule 37. Payment to purdah-nashin women

- Where a Money Order is payable to a purdah-nashin woman who has no authorised agent, the signature or mark of the payee must be attested by a witness known to the postman or paying officer.
- If the witness is not known to the postman or such officer, he must be identified.
- The witness must certify on the Money Order that the payment was made to the purdah-nashin woman in his presence.

Rule 38. Payment to minors

- A Money Order payable to a minor must be paid to the father or lawful guardian of the minor.
- The father or guardian signs the Money Order and acknowledgement on behalf of the minor.
- If the minor has no father or lawful guardian living with him, the Money Order may be paid to the person in whose care and custody the minor is for the time being, provided that such person signs an indemnity bond in the prescribed form.

Rule 39. Payment to lunatics

- A Money Order payable to a lunatic must be paid to the manager of his estate, if one has been appointed.
- If no manager has been appointed, the Money Order may be paid to the person in whose care and custody the lunatic is for the time being, on his signing an indemnity bond in the prescribed form.

Rule 40. Payment of Void Money Orders

- A Money Order not paid within the period of currency allowed by the rules becomes void.
- The amount of a void Money Order can be paid only on the authority of the Head of the Circle or such other officer as may be empowered in this behalf.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Void / forfeiture timeline

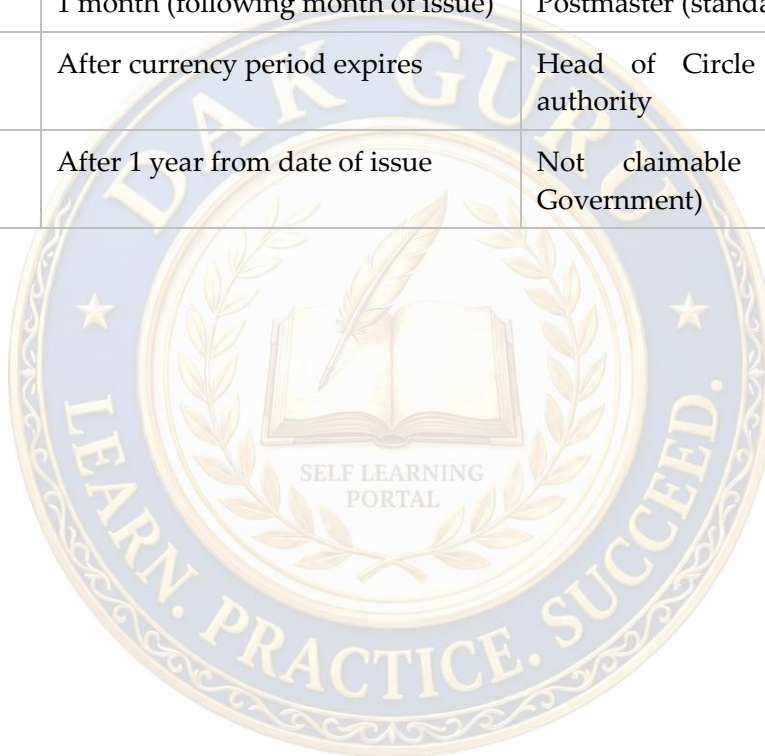
- **Currency period:** 1 month following the month of issue.
- **Void status:** after the currency period expires.

- **Forfeiture:** if no claim is made within 1 year of the date of issue, the amount is credited to the Government and is not thereafter claimable.

Note on citation: Section 44 of the (repealed) Indian Post Office Act, 1898 dealt with forfeiture of unclaimed Money Orders. Under the new framework, this subject-matter is now governed by the Post Office Regulations, 2024 (made under Section 7 of the 2023 Act). Earlier study material had referred to "Section 47" of the 2023 Act; that citation is incorrect, as the 2023 Act has only 11 sections in total.

Data Schedule — Validity & Claim Periods

Status	Timeline / condition	Authority for payment
Currency Period	1 month (following month of issue)	Postmaster (standard payment)
Void (Unpaid)	After currency period expires	Head of Circle / designated authority
Forfeiture	After 1 year from date of issue	Not claimable (credited to Government)



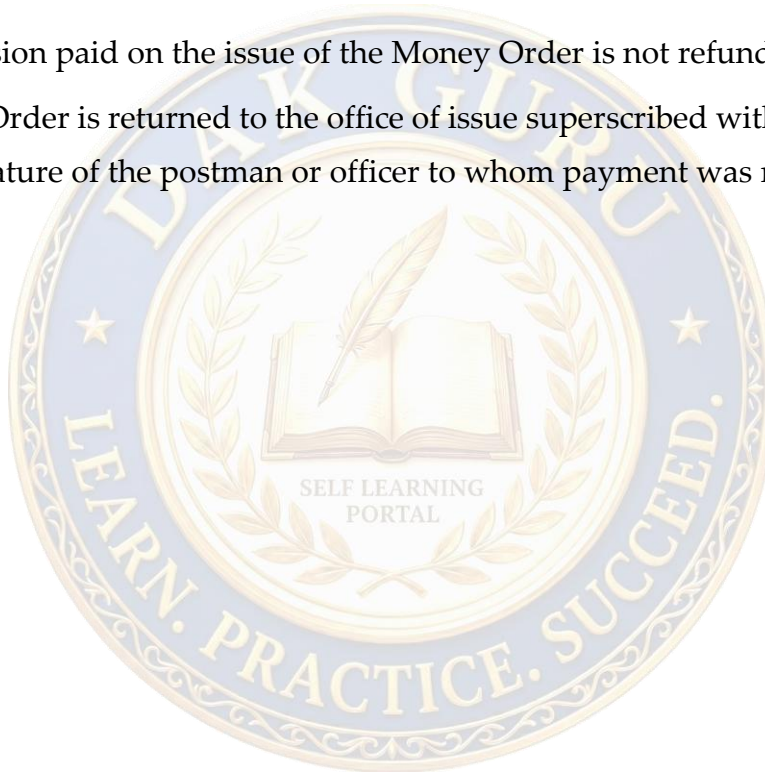
Chapter IV — Refusal of Payment

Legal context

The procedural rights of the remitter and the payee with respect to changes to a Money Order after issue are supported by the Post Office Act, 2023 — particularly the Central Government's power under Section 7 to make rules prescribing rates and conditions for postal services.

Rule 41. Refusal of payment by payee

- If the payee refuses to take payment of a Money Order, the amount of the order is returned to the remitter.
- The commission paid on the issue of the Money Order is not refunded.
- The Money Order is returned to the office of issue superscribed with the word "Refused" and the signature of the postman or officer to whom payment was refused.



Chapter V — Alteration of Address or Payee's Name

Rule 42. Alteration of address or name of payee

- The remitter of a Money Order which has not been paid may require that the address of the payee be altered or that the name of the payee be changed.
- The remitter must apply in writing to the post office at which the order was issued, and must produce the receipt given to him for the order.
- If the Money Order has not left the office of issue, the alteration is made at once without charge.
- If the Money Order has been despatched, the application is forwarded to the office of payment.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Fees for alteration of instructions

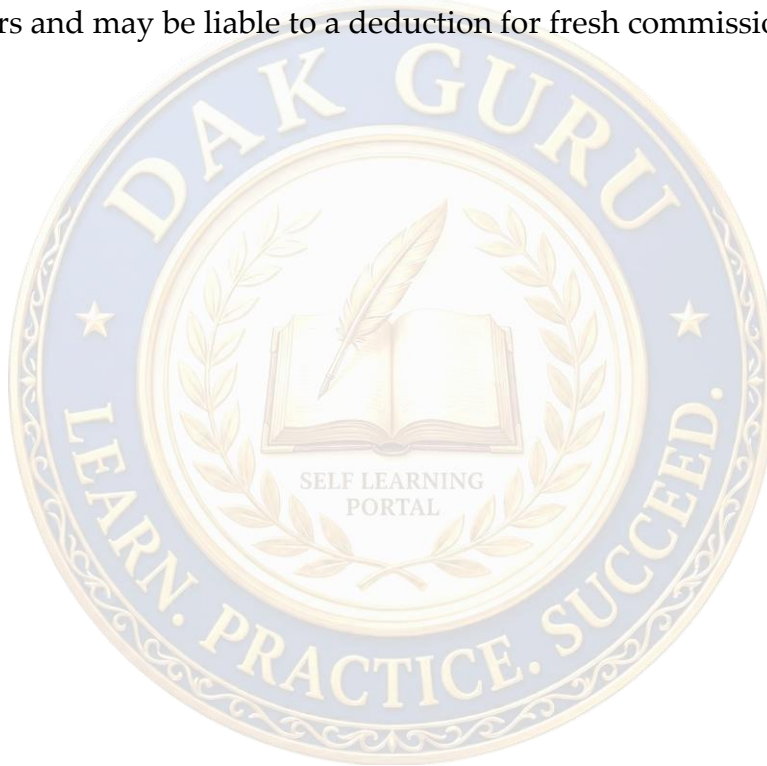
Source: Revised Schedule of Fees (2024) under the new Act.

- Applications for alteration of payee name or address after the Money Order has left the office of issue may be subject to a service charge equivalent to the postage of a standard letter or a specific administrative fee, unless waived by the Head of Circle.
- Alteration only of the payee's address within India, or repayment to the remitter, continues to be free of charge.

Chapter VI — Redirection

Rule 43. Redirection of Money Orders

- A Money Order may be redirected to the payee at a new address on his written request or on the written request of the remitter.
- Inland Money Orders: redirection of an inland Money Order is effected free of charge.
- The instructions regarding redirection of articles of the Letter Mail apply generally to the redirection of Money Orders.
- A Money Order redirected to a foreign country is subject to the rules governing Foreign Money Orders and may be liable to a deduction for fresh commission.



Chapter VII — Stoppage of Payment

Rule 44. Stoppage of payment

- The remitter of a Money Order may stop payment of the amount to the payee and require that the money be repaid to himself.
- The remitter applies in writing to the post office at which the Money Order was issued and produces the receipt.
- The Postmaster records the request and, if the order has been despatched, communicates with the office of payment by the quickest available means (including electronic transmission).
- The Post Office is not liable if payment is made to the payee before the stop-payment instructions reach the paying office.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Limitation of liability

Section 10, Post Office Act 2023: the Government incurs no liability for the payment of a Money Order to the payee if the stop-payment request was not received in time to prevent such payment. The onus of proving the timing of the request lies on the remitter.

Data Schedule — Service Requests & Fees

Service Request	Condition	Fee / charge (current status)
Refusal by Payee	Return to remitter	Commission forfeited
Alteration of Payee	Before despatch	Free
Alteration of Payee	After despatch	Subject to administrative fee, if any
Redirection (Inland)	Within India	Free
Stoppage of Payment	Before payment	Free (but commission not refunded)

Chapter VIII — Indian Postal Orders

Exam alert

Indian Postal Orders (IPOs) are a high-frequency topic in departmental examinations. Pay strict attention to Rule 180-D (Period of Currency) and Rule 180-B (the "breakage" rule on affixing stamps), which are tested repeatedly.

Rule 180. Supply and Sale

- Indian Postal Orders are available in denominations of Re. 1, Rs. 2, Rs. 5, Rs. 10, Rs. 20, Rs. 50 and Rs. 100.
- They are sold at all Head and Sub-Post Offices and at such Branch Post Offices as may be authorised in this behalf.

STATUTORY UPDATE — eIPO availability

- In addition to physical IPOs, **Electronic Indian Postal Orders (eIPO)** are available for Indian citizens (in India and abroad) to pay fees under the Right to Information Act, 2005.
- eIPO denominations:** primarily Rs. 10, Rs. 20, Rs. 50 and Rs. 100.

Rule 180-A. Commission

- The commission payable on the issue of Indian Postal Orders is at the rates prescribed by the Central Government from time to time.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Current commission rates (Post Office Guide Part II)

IPO denomination	Commission (fee)
Up to Rs. 10	Re. 1.00
Rs. 20	Rs. 2.00
Rs. 50	Rs. 5.00
Rs. 100	Rs. 10.00

Rule 180-B. Broken Amounts (Stamp-affixing rule)

- If a remitter wishes to remit a sum which includes a fraction of a rupee or a sum not equal to one of the fixed denominations, he may make up the difference by affixing unused postage stamps to the face of the Postal Order.

Conditions for affixing stamps:

- the number of stamps affixed must not exceed 4;
- the total value of stamps affixed must not exceed Rs. 3 (Three Rupees);
- stamps must be affixed in the space provided on the face of the order.

Rule 180-C. Crossing of Postal Orders

- An Indian Postal Order may be crossed generally or specially, like a cheque.
- General crossing: if the order bears across its face two parallel transverse lines, payment is made only to a banker.
- Special crossing: if the name of a bank is added between the lines, payment is made only to that specific bank.

Rule 180-D. Period of Currency (Validity)

- Indian Postal Orders presented for payment within 24 months (2 years) from the last day of the month of issue are encashable without a second commission.
- If presented after 24 months but before 36 months (3 years), they are paid only on payment of a second commission.
- The second commission must be paid in postage stamps affixed to the back of the order.
- Orders presented more than 36 months (3 years) after the last day of the month of issue are time-barred and forfeited.

STATUTORY CLARIFICATION — Worked example

If an IPO is issued on 15 January 2023, the "last day of the month of issue" is **31 January 2023**. The validity timeline is then:

- **First period (no fee):** valid until 31 January 2025.
- **Second period (with fee):** valid until 31 January 2026.
- **Forfeited:** after 31 January 2026.

Rule 183. Payment to the Public

- The payee must sign the order in ink in the space provided for "Received the sum of ...".
- If the payee is illiterate, his mark or thumb-impression must be attested by a witness known to the Postmaster or identified to his satisfaction.

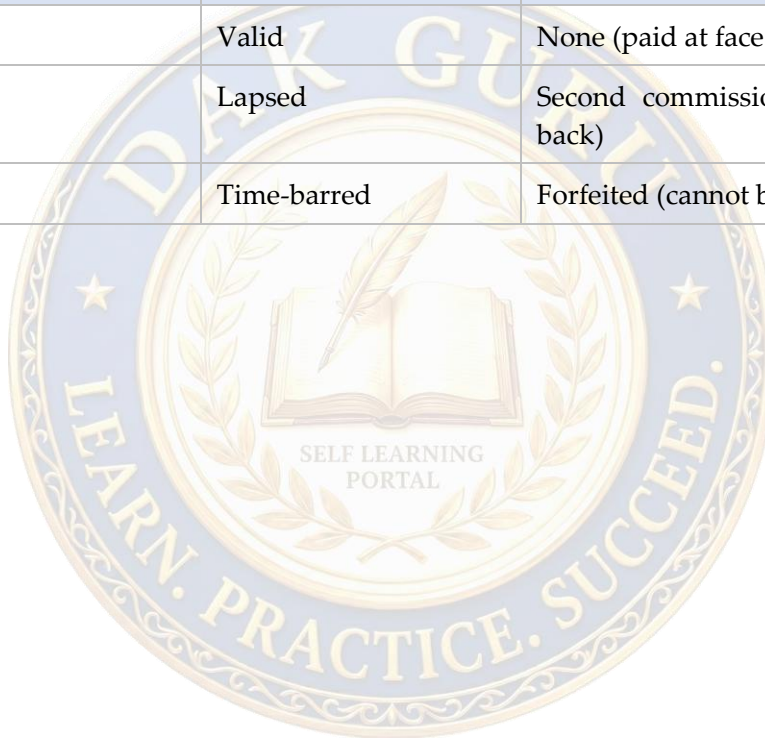
- The paying Postmaster must verify that the order is genuine, bears the date-stamp of the office of issue, and has not been altered or erased.

Rule 189. Repayment to Purchaser

- The purchaser of an Indian Postal Order may obtain repayment of its value (but not the commission) by presenting the order and the counterfoil at the office of issue.
- He must sign the receipt on the order, adding the word "Purchaser" after his signature.

Data Schedule — IPO Validity Timeline

Time from last day of month of issue	Status	Requirement for payment
0 – 24 months	Valid	None (paid at face value)
24 – 36 months	Lapsed	Second commission (stamps on back)
> 36 months	Time-barred	Forfeited (cannot be paid)



Chapter IX — Miscellaneous Rules (Void Orders & Preservation of Records)

Rule 210. Void Money Orders

- A Money Order not paid within the period of currency allowed by the rules (normally one year for forfeiture) becomes void.
- The amount of a void Money Order is credited to the Central Government.
- If a claim is subsequently made by the remitter or payee, payment can be sanctioned only by the Head of the Circle (CPM/PMG) or a competent authority delegated with such financial powers.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Claims on void orders

- Claims for void Money Orders must be made within the statutory limitation period.
- Once the amount is credited to the Government as "unclaimed", the procedure for refund involves strict verification of the claimant's identity and the original transaction records (which are preserved for limited periods — typically 18 months for MO records).

Note on citation: Earlier study material had referred to "Section 47, Post Office Act 2023". This citation is incorrect — the 2023 Act has only 11 sections. The forfeiture position is now governed by the Post Office Regulations, 2024 (made under Section 7 of the 2023 Act).

Rule 212. Preservation of Records

- The journals and accounts relating to Money-Order business must be preserved for the periods prescribed in Postal Manual Volume VIII (Rules on Preservation of Records).
- Generally, Money-Order paid vouchers are preserved for 18 months.

Annexure — Preservation of Money-Order Records

(Reference: Rule 212 of Vol VI, Pt II, and the Appendix to Vol VIII)

Journals, accounts and books relating to Money-Order business are preserved for the periods specified below, calculated generally from the completion of the record or the close of the year to which they relate.

I. Essential Registers & Journals

Record name	Form No.	Preservation period
Book of MO Receipts	MO-1	2 years
Journal of MOs Issued	MO-2	18 months
Register of MOs Received	MO-3	18 months
Journal of MOs Paid	MO-4	18 months
Compilation of MOs Paid	MO-20 / MO-23	18 months
Compilation of Daily Totals (Issued)	MO-22	18 months
Postman's Book	MS-27	18 months

II. Specialised Money-Order Records

Record name	Description	Preservation period
Bulk Money-Order Lists	Lists presented by remitters for bulk booking	6 months
TMO / eMO Advice	Telegraphic / Electronic MO advice received	18 months
Foreign Money Orders	Records of Inward / Outward exchange offices	3 years
Audit Case Files	Files containing paid MOs received from Audit	2 years
Round Money-Order Stamp	Impression book (if separately maintained)	18 months

III. General Accounts (Applicable to MO Branch)

Record name	Form No.	Preservation period
Sub-Office Daily Account	ACG-22	18 months
Sub-Office Slip	PA-3	18 months
Branch Office Daily Account	ACG-22 (B)	2 years
Branch Office Slip	PA-5	2 years
Treasury Remittance Book	ACG-8	10 years

Digital context — APT 2.0 (2025–26)

- **Physical retention:** the periods above apply strictly to physical printouts, counterfoils and journals generated at the post office.

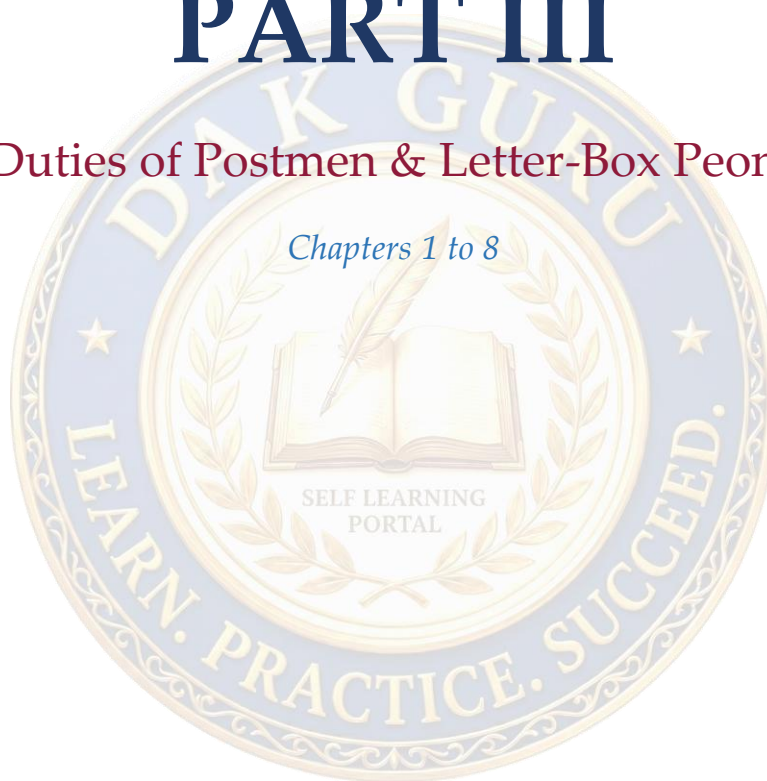
Record name	Form No.	Preservation period
• Digital archives: in the APT 2.0 environment, transaction data (eMO booking / payment logs) is archived centrally on the server for periods often exceeding 10 years for audit trails, independent of physical-record destruction. • Destruction protocol: no record may be destroyed without the specific order of the Head of the Office (Postmaster / Superintendent), after verifying that no audit objection or inquiry is pending against the relevant period.		



PART III

Duties of Postmen & Letter-Box Peons

Chapters 1 to 8



Chapter 1 — Duties of Postmen (General)

Rule 1. Head Postmen

- Head Postmen are employed in all large offices to convey money to and from the treasury / bank, to distribute the work of the delivery department, to examine the postmen's books and to perform other special duties.
- They may also be employed to make inquiries into minor complaints and to verify the payment of Money Orders.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Underlying framework

The operational role of Head Postmen continues; the underlying statutory framework is now the Post Office Act, 2023 (in force from 18 June 2024, replacing the Indian Post Office Act, 1898) read with the Post Office Regulations, 2024 (S.O. 5440(E) dated 16 December 2024).

Rule 2. Knowledge of Postal Business

- Postmen must know thoroughly the rates of inland postage, the commission on Money Orders, the charges for insurance and the fee for registration.
- They must be fully competent to fill up the forms with which the public ordinarily deal — especially Money-Order forms and forms relating to the Value Payable (V.P.) system.
- They must be able to describe the principal features and advantages of the Savings Bank, Post Office Certificates, Money Order, Registration and other postal systems.

Rule 3. Supply of Forms to be Carried

Every postman must carry with him a stock of:

- Money-Order forms;
- Acknowledgement forms;
- Forms of application for the purchase of Postal Certificates;
- Savings Bank deposit forms.
- He should also carry a small stock of postage stamps and stationery for sale to the public.

Rule 4. Postman's Book (Form Ms-27)

- Every postman is supplied with a book in Form Ms-27, in which he enters the particulars of all Registered, Insured and Value Payable articles, and Money Orders entrusted to him for delivery or payment.
- The Postman's Book is examined and initialled by the Postmaster or Head Postman daily, before the postman proceeds on his beat and on his return.

Rule 5. Addresses to be Noted on Articles

- The postman must note the name of the addressee on articles made over to him for delivery wherever he cannot himself read the language in which the address is written.
- This rule applies especially to articles addressed in English delivered by postmen not conversant with that language.
- Assistance in reading addresses should be obtained from the Head Postman or other officers of the post office.

Rule 6. Damaged Articles to be Noticed

- A postman must not receive any article which appears to be damaged or tampered with, without bringing the fact to the notice of the Postmaster or the officer-in-charge of the delivery department.
- If he detects any injury to an article after it has been made over to him, he must immediately show it to the Postmaster.

Rule 7. Receipts for Articles Issued for Delivery

- The postman must give a receipt to the Registration / Parcel Assistant or the Treasurer for all registered, insured and V.P. articles, and Money Orders made over to him for delivery.
- The receipt is given in the designated columns of the registers or lists from which the articles are issued.

Rule 8. Book of Receipts for Intimations and Notices Delivered

- Postmen are supplied with a book of receipts (Form Rp-53) for intimations and notices delivered by them.

- When a postman delivers an intimation regarding a Value Payable article or an Insured article exceeding Rs. 500 (Manual limit), he must obtain the signature of the addressee in this book.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Doorstep delivery limits in practice

The Manual figure of Rs. 500 continues to be the examination-default. In operational practice, doorstep cash-handling limits for postmen / GDS have been enhanced by SB Orders (e.g., for AePS-linked transactions and specific IPPB activities). For Vol. VI Part III examination purposes, use Rs. 500 unless the question expressly asks for the "current ruling".

Rule 9. Instructions for Delivery

- Each postman's beat is fixed by the Postmaster, and he must on no account deviate from the beat prescribed.
- He must deliver articles at the address given on them.
- If the addressee cannot be found at the given address, enquiry regarding his changed address should be made from the neighbours.
- Postmen, while on duty, are prohibited from distributing advertisements, handbills, trade circulars or notices of any description on behalf of members of the public.

Rule 10. Realisation of Postage Before Delivery

- A postman is forbidden to deliver any article on which postage, customs duty or any other sum is due, until the full amount has been realised.
- He is not bound to give change.
- If the addressee refuses to pay the amount due, the article is taken back to the post office and treated as refused.

Chapter 2 — Delivery of Special Articles

Rule 11. Receipts of Addressees for Registered Articles

- A postman must not deliver a Registered (now accountable Speed Post) letter or packet without obtaining the signature of the addressee (or his agent) on the receipt and acknowledgement (if any).
- The signature must be taken in ink or indelible pencil.

Rule 12. Delivery to Illiterate Addressees

- When a registered article is delivered to an illiterate addressee, his thumb-impression or other mark is taken on the receipt and acknowledgement.
- The mark or impression must be attested by a respectable witness who is personally known to the postman or identified to his satisfaction.
- The postman himself cannot attest the mark / impression.

Rule 13. Delivery of Insured Articles

- Insured articles must be delivered only to the addressee or his authorised agent.
- Insured articles exceeding the value of Rs. 500 (Manual limit) must not be delivered by the postman: an intimation is delivered instead.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Operational note

Operational SB Orders have enhanced cash-handling limits for postmen / GDS in many circumstances (e.g., AePS / cash withdrawal at the doorstep up to Rs. 40,000 in some Circles). For Vol. VI Part III examination, however, retain the Rs. 500 limit for insured articles unless the question specifies "current ruling".

Rule 14. Payment of e-Money Orders

- Money Orders (now primarily e-MOs) must be paid to the payee named in the order at the address given.
- The postman must satisfy himself as to the identity of the payee.
- The signature of the payee must be obtained on the Money Order and the acknowledgement.

Summary of Important Forms (Vol. VI, Part III)

Form No.	Description
Ms-27	Postman's Book
Rp-53	Book of Receipts for Intimations / Notices
Rp-54	V.P. Intimation
M-1	Cash Bag (general)
M-2	Transit Bag
Pa-11	Sub-Account (Village Postman)
M-52	Village Sorting List
M-53	Route List (Village Postman)

Rule 15. Articles Addressed to Minors

- Articles addressed to minors should always be delivered to them in the presence of their parents or guardians, or to the parents or guardians themselves.
- If the minor is not living with his parent or guardian, the article may be delivered to the minor himself, provided the postman is satisfied that the minor is able to understand the nature of the transaction.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Liability and good-faith delivery

Section 10, Post Office Act, 2023: the Central Government incurs no liability for mis-delivery executed in good faith according to the prescribed rules. Operational instructions now favour verified delivery (e.g., OTP-based or digital signature) where the addressee is a minor, to avoid disputes.

Rule 16. Articles Addressed to Lunatics

- Articles addressed to lunatics should be delivered to their managers or legal guardians, if any.
- If there is no manager or legal guardian, the articles must be taken back to the post office and the Postmaster's orders obtained.

Rule 17. Delivery of Articles on which Customs Duty is Due

- When an article on which customs duty is due is made over to a postman for delivery, he must recover the amount of the duty from the addressee before delivering the article.

- The postman is not authorised to open the article to allow the addressee to examine the contents before payment of the duty.
- The receipt for the customs duty (usually pasted on the article) must be signed by the postman and given to the addressee.

Rule 18. Delivery of Articles on which Demurrage Fee is Due

- If a demurrage fee (warehousing charge) is due on a parcel or other article, the postman must recover the fee in addition to any other charges due before delivery.
- The amount of demurrage due is noted on the article or the accompanying receipt.

Rule 19. Doubtful Cases

- In any case of doubt as to the identity of the addressee or the person claiming delivery, or if the addressee refuses to sign the receipt or acknowledgement, the postman must bring the article back to the post office.

Rule 20. Delivery of Value Payable (V.P.) Articles

- A V.P. article can be delivered only on payment of the amount specified for remittance to the sender, together with the commission on the Money Order.
- The postman must obtain the signature of the addressee on the receipt and the V.P. Money-Order form.
- If the addressee complains of the condition of the article or suspects that it has been tampered with, the postman must not deliver it but must bring it back to the post office.

Rule 21. Intimation of V.P. Articles

- When a V.P. article exceeds Rs. 500 in value, or exceeds the limit prescribed for delivery by a single postman, the article is not sent out for delivery; instead, an intimation (Form Rp-54) is prepared and made over to the postman for delivery to the addressee.
- The postman delivers the intimation and obtains the addressee's signature in his Book of Receipts for Intimations (Form Rp-53).

STATUTORY UPDATE — V.P. / COD doorstep limits in practice

Operational circulars have enhanced the door-delivery threshold for V.P. / COD articles (often Rs. 5,000 or higher depending on Circle / city classification). The Manual figure of Rs. 500 remains the examination-default unless the question expressly asks for the "current ruling".

Chapter 3 — Payment of Money Orders by Postmen

Rule 23. Payment of Money Orders (General)

- Money Orders (now primarily e-MOs) made over to a postman for payment must be paid to the payee named in the order.
- The postman takes the payee's signature on the Money Order and on the Acknowledgement.
- He also signs the Money Order himself in the space provided for the "Postman's Signature".

STATUTORY UPDATE — Smart Postman / digital acknowledgement

With the rollout of DARPAN 2.0 and Smart Postman devices, the physical signature is often replaced or supplemented by biometric authentication or digital signature on the mobile device. The acknowledgement is then often digital (SMS confirmation to the sender).

Rule 24. Payment to Illiterate Payees

- If the payee is illiterate, his thumb-impression or other mark is taken on the Money Order and Acknowledgement.
- The mark is attested by a respectable witness who is personally known to the postman or identified to his satisfaction.
- The postman enters the name and address of the witness on the Money Order.

Rule 25. Payment to Purdah-Nashin Women

- If the payee is a purdah-nashin woman (a woman who does not appear in public), the Money Order is paid to her in the presence of a witness who can identify her.
- If she is illiterate, her mark is obtained and attested by a witness.
- The postman must satisfy himself that payment actually reaches the proper person.

Rule 26. Payment of Money Orders to Minors

- A Money Order payable to a minor must be paid to the parent or legal guardian with whom the minor is living.

- The parent or guardian signs the Money Order on behalf of the minor (e.g., "X, father and guardian of Y").
- If the minor is of sufficient age and discretion (usually above 12 years, subject to local discretion) and is living apart from his parents / guardians, payment may be made to the minor himself.

Rule 27. Payment of Money Orders to Lunatics

- Money Orders payable to persons of unsound mind are paid only to the Manager of the estate or the legally appointed guardian.
- Under no circumstances is payment made to the lunatic himself.

Rule 28. Identification of Payee

- The postman is responsible for the correct payment of the Money Order.
- If the payee is not permanently resident in the postman's beat, or is not personally known to him, the postman must require the payee to be identified by some respectable person known to the postman.
- The identifier signs the Money Order in the space provided.

Rule 29. Payment by Village Postman

- A Village Postman is authorised to pay Money Orders up to the limit of cash entrusted to him.
- He proceeds under the same rules as a regular postman regarding identification and receipts.

Rule 30. Money Orders Not Paid (Void / Refused)

- If the payee refuses to take payment, or cannot be found, or if the payee is deceased, the Money Order is brought back to the post office.
- The postman notes the reason for non-payment (e.g., "Refused", "Left", "Deceased") on the Money Order.
- In case of "Refused", the refusal is attested by the postman.

Chapter 4 — Cash Conveyance & Sub-Accounts

Rule 31. Conveyance of Cash by Postmen

- When a postman is required to convey cash between the treasury / bank and the post office, or between two post offices, he must be provided with a leather cash bag (Form M-1) or a canvas bag with a lock and key.
- The maximum amount of cash that can be entrusted to a single postman is limited as below.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Cash conveyance limits (Security Branch instructions, 2024 update)

Mode of conveyance	Maximum amount
Single postman / GDS (foot or public transport)	Up to Rs. 2,00,000
Single postman / GDS (departmental or hired vehicle)	Up to Rs. 5,00,000
Two officials with armed guard	Above Rs. 5,00,000 and up to Rs. 25,00,000

Reference: Directorate Letter No. 25-14/2021-Security, as updated in 2024.

Rule 32. Sub-Account System (Village Postmen)

- Village Postmen entrusted with cash and stamps for Sub-Offices or Branch Offices on their beat must carry a Sub-Account Portfolio.
- The portfolio contains the Sub-Account (Form Pa-11), the cash bag and the registered / insured articles.
- The Village Postman is responsible for the safe custody of the portfolio and its contents while on his beat.

Rule 33. Exchange of Sub-Accounts

- On reaching a Sub-Office or Branch Office, the Village Postman makes over the Sub-Account Portfolio to the Sub-Postmaster or Branch Postmaster.
- He waits until the portfolio is returned to him with the return Sub-Account and the articles / cash for the Head Office or Account Office.
- He checks the contents of the portfolio in the presence of the Sub / Branch Postmaster before leaving the office.

Chapter 5 — Duties of Head Postmen

Rule 36. General Duties

- The Head Postman is responsible for the general supervision of the delivery work.
- He must see that postmen attend office punctually and are neat and clean in appearance.
- He must ensure that postmen leave the office for their beats at the prescribed time.

Rule 37. Testing of Letter Boxes

- The Head Postman is required to test the letter boxes on the postmen's beats to ensure that they are cleared punctually.
- He drops test letters into the letter boxes at different times and watches for their arrival at the post office. Any irregularity or delay in clearance is reported to the Postmaster.

Rule 38. Verification of Payment of Money Orders

- The Head Postman is employed to verify the payment of Money Orders.
- He visits the payees of a percentage of Money Orders paid by each postman to ascertain whether the amounts were paid in full and without demand for illegal gratification.
- The result of his enquiries is noted in a Visit Book or Diary.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Digital monitoring

Verification targets are now monitored digitally. The Head Postman (or PRI / Overseer) must verify 100% of MOs exceeding a certain value (e.g., Rs. 5,000) and a percentage of lower-value MOs, entering findings in the Postman Mobile App where available.

Rule 39. Enquiry into Complaints

- Minor complaints from the public regarding delivery of letters or the conduct of postmen may be made over to the Head Postman for enquiry.
- He submits a written report of the result of his enquiry to the Postmaster.

Rule 40. Taking out Letter-Box Keys

- The Head Postman may be entrusted with the master key of the letter boxes to inspect the interior of the boxes.
- He must account for the key whenever it is taken out and returned.

Chapter 6 — Duties of Letter-Box Attendants

Rule 41. Clearance of Letter Boxes

- Letter-Box Peons (or Attendants) are employed to clear street letter boxes.
- They must clear the boxes strictly in accordance with the hours of clearance shown on the hour-plates. They bring the contents of the boxes to the post office immediately after clearance.

Rule 42. Changing of Hour-Plates

- At each clearance, the Letter-Box Peon must change the hour-plate to show the time of the next clearance.
- If the box is provided with a movable indicator, he adjusts it to the proper time.
- Failure to change the hour-plate is a serious irregularity.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Smart Letter Boxes (Nanyatha)

Many modern "Smart Letter Boxes" (Nanyatha) carry a barcoded sticker inside. The attendant must scan the barcode using the Nanyatha App on his mobile device to log the clearance time and location (GPS-tagged) electronically. The physical hour-plate rules continue to apply unless the box is fully digital.

Rule 43. Security of Letter-Box Keys

- The key of the letter box must be kept attached to the peon's person by a chain or strap. He must not allow the key to pass out of his custody or lend it to anyone.

Rule 44. Damaged Letter Boxes

- If a Letter-Box Peon finds a letter box damaged, insecure or tampered with, he must not clear it but must guard it and send word to the post office for assistance. He must report the matter to the Postmaster immediately.

Rule 45. Examination of Locks

- The Letter-Box Peon examines the lock of every letter box he clears to see that it is in good order. If the lock is stiff or difficult to open, he reports the fact to the Postmaster so that it may be oiled or repaired.

Chapter 7 — Uniforms and Badges

Rule 46. Supply of Uniforms

- Postmen and Letter-Box Peons are supplied with uniforms and warm clothing (liveries) at Government expense.
- They are required to wear their uniforms while on duty.
- Officials not wearing the prescribed uniform are liable to be treated as absent from duty.

STATUTORY UPDATE — 7th CPC Dress Allowance

The 7th CPC Dress Allowance has replaced the physical supply of uniforms for most cadres. Eligible employees receive a Dress Allowance (currently Rs. 5,000 per annum) credited directly to salary in July, and are expected to procure and maintain the prescribed khaki / blue uniforms themselves.

Rule 47. Maintenance of Uniforms

- Postmen must keep their uniforms clean and in good repair.
- They must not modify the pattern of the uniform supplied to them.
- A postman appearing for duty in a dirty or untidy uniform is liable to punishment.

Rule 48. Badges

- Every postman and Letter-Box Peon is supplied with a badge (usually brass or metal) bearing the word "Postman" or "Letter Box Peon" and a number.
- The badge is worn in a conspicuous place on the left breast of the coat or tunic.
- A postman must not go on his beat without his badge.

Rule 49. Umbrellas and Raincoats

- Umbrellas or waterproof capes / raincoats are supplied to postmen and Letter-Box Peons in localities where the rainfall is heavy.
- These articles remain the property of Government and must be returned to the office when the official leaves the service or proceeds on long leave.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Decentralisation of procurement

Procurement of raincoats is now decentralised to Circle / Divisional Heads, or covered under the enhanced Dress Allowance and specific "Hard Area" allowances.

Rule 50. Renewal of Liveries

- Periods of wear for various articles of livery (coats, turbans, boots, etc.) are prescribed by the Head of the Circle.
- An article cannot be renewed before the expiry of the prescribed period unless it has been lost or damaged through no fault of the official.



Chapter 8 — Prohibitions, Offences & Village Postmen

Rule 55. Prohibition against engaging in Trade or Business

- A postman is prohibited from engaging in any trade or business on his own account.
- He must not act as an agent for any firm or dealer.
- He is forbidden to distribute advertisements, handbills or trade circulars for the public while on duty.

Rule 56. Prohibition against acting as Professional Letter-Writer

- A postman is forbidden to act as a professional letter-writer.
- He may assist illiterate persons in reading or writing letters gratuitously (without payment), provided it does not interfere with his regular duties.

Rule 57. Prohibition against Money Lending

- Postmen are strictly prohibited from lending money on interest to the public or to other postal officials.
- They must not borrow money from persons residing on their beats.

Rule 58. Offences punishable under the Post Office Act

Postmen should be aware that the following acts are offences:

- wilful detention or delay of any postal article;
- opening or tampering with any postal article;
- making away with (theft / destruction of) any postal article;
- falsely noting "Refused", "Addressee not found" or "Left" on an article;
- demanding more postage than is due.

STATUTORY UPDATE — Offences under the Post Office Act, 2023

The Post Office Act, 2023 (in force from 18 June 2024) replaced the Indian Post Office Act, 1898. The Act has only 11 sections in total. The principal penal provisions are:

- **Section 7:** the Central Government may make rules — and the Director-General may make regulations (Section 13) — prescribing the conditions and standards for postal services, including the consequences of breach.

- **Section 9:** powers of interception of postal articles by officers empowered by the Central Government, on the grounds of public emergency, public safety, security of the State, friendly relations with foreign States, public order, or prevention of incitement to the commission of any offence.
- **Section 10:** limitation of Government liability — no liability for loss, mis-delivery, delay or damage to any item, except as may be prescribed.

Earlier study material referred to a "Section 47" of the 2023 Act; that citation is incorrect. The 2023 Act has only 11 sections and contains no Section 47.

Rule 59. Prohibition against giving Information

- A postman must not give any information to the public regarding the receipt or despatch of mails or the addresses of persons served by the post office.
- He must not give information regarding the value of articles delivered to any person.

Rule 60. Loitering and Deviation from Beat

- A postman must not loiter on his beat or waste time in conversation.
- He must not deviate from the prescribed route of his beat without valid reason.
- If he is found to be habitually irregular in his beat, he is liable to severe punishment.

Duties of Village Postmen

Rule 61. Definition and Beat

- Village Postmen are attached to Head or Sub-Offices for the delivery of correspondence in rural tracts.
- A Village Postman's beat includes a number of villages which he visits at fixed intervals.

STATUTORY UPDATE — GDS in current context

In the modern context, the duties described in this section are primarily performed by Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDS) — specifically the Assistant Branch Postmaster (ABPM) for delivery and conveyance and the Branch Postmaster (BPM) for office management. Although the Manual uses the term "Village Postman", examinations often test the GDS rules alongside.

Rule 62. Route List and Beat Map

- Every Village Postman is supplied with a Route List (Form M-53) showing the names of the villages on his beat, the days on which they are to be visited and the hours of arrival and departure.
- He is also supplied with a Beat Map showing the villages and the route to be followed.
- He must strictly adhere to the route and timings prescribed.

Rule 63. Attendance and Examination of Contents

- The Village Postman attends the post office at the prescribed hour to receive the articles for delivery.
- He examines the articles made over to him to see that they are in good condition and that the acknowledgements for registered / insured articles are attached.
- He checks the entries in the Sub-Account or Register against the articles received.

Rule 64. Forms and Stock

A Village Postman must carry a stock of:

- Postage Stamps and Stationery for sale;
- Money-Order forms;
- Acknowledgement forms;
- Common Proof of Delivery (CPD) cards, if applicable.
- He must also carry a pencil and a stamp pad (ink pad) for taking thumb-impressions.

Rule 65. Delivery of Articles in Villages

- On arriving at a village, the Village Postman proceeds to the usual place of resort (e.g., the village chavadi or headman's house) or goes from house to house to deliver articles.
- He must not detain articles for a future visit if the addressee is present in the village.
- If the addressee is not found, the article may be delivered to a responsible member of his family (subject to rules for specific articles), or kept for the next visit if the addressee is expected to return shortly (within the limit of retention).

Rule 66. Articles for Persons who have Left

- If the addressee has left the village and his new address is known, the Village Postman notes the new address on the article and returns it to the post office for redirection.
- If the new address is not known, the article is noted "Left without instructions" and returned.

Rule 67. Collection of Articles for Despatch

- The Village Postman is authorised to receive unregistered letters and postcards from the public for despatch.
- He must see that such articles are fully prepaid with postage stamps.
- He cannot accept Registered or Insured articles or Money Orders for booking unless specifically authorised.

STATUTORY UPDATE — DARPAN 2.0 booking by GDS

Under current DARPAN 2.0 implementations, GDS (BPMs / ABPMs) provided with mobile devices can book Speed Post (Documents and Parcels) — which now subsumes Registered articles — and also accept eMOs while on the beat, generating a digital receipt.

Rule 68. Clearance of Letter Boxes

- The Village Postman clears all letter boxes situated in the villages on his beat.
- He clears them at the hours specified in his Route List.
- He locks the boxes securely after clearance.

Rule 69. Sale of Stamps

- The Village Postman is required to sell postage stamps and stationery to the public for cash.
- He must not sell stamps on credit.
- The cash realised from sales is kept distinct from other cash (such as Money-Order cash).

Rule 70. Procedure for Registered Articles

- Registered articles are delivered only to the addressee or his agent.
- The signature is taken on the receipt and acknowledgement.
- If the addressee is illiterate, the procedure for thumb-impression and witness-attestation (per Rule 12 / Rule 24) must be followed strictly.

Rule 71. Limit of Cash for Payment

- The aggregate value of Money Orders and Insured Articles entrusted to a Village Postman for payment at one time must not exceed the limit fixed by the Superintendent of Post Offices.
- Normally this limit is lower than that for a town postman.

STATUTORY UPDATE — GDS cash limits

- **Cash-handling limit (standard):** up to Rs. 50,000 (subject to Circle-level authorisation; higher in specific cases).
- **Note:** Always check the latest Circle-level notification for specific "Line Limits" and AePS / IPPB transaction ceilings.

Rule 72. Overnight Halts

- If a Village Postman's beat is too large to be covered in one day, he may be required to halt overnight at a specified village.
- He must sleep at a secure place (e.g., school, panchayat office or headman's house) approved by the Postmaster.
- He is responsible for the safety of the cash and mails during the halt.

Rule 73. Return to Office

On his return to the post office, the Village Postman delivers:

- all undelivered articles;
- the signed receipts / acknowledgements for delivered articles;
- the cash realised from V.P. articles and Customs Duty;
- the cash from the sale of stamps (for replenishment of stock);
- the articles collected from letter boxes.

Rule 74. Infectious Diseases

- If a Village Postman knows that plague, smallpox or any other dangerous infectious disease constitutes a specific danger in any village on his beat, he must not enter that village.
- He reports the fact to the Postmaster immediately.
- Articles for such villages are detained at the post office until it is safe to deliver them.

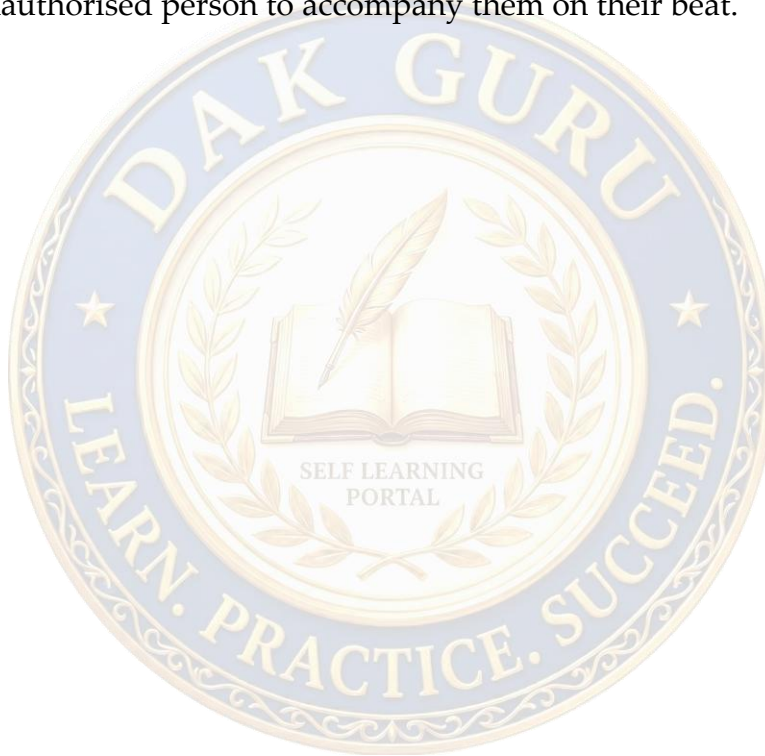
🔔 STATUTORY UPDATE — Modern context

While "plague / smallpox" are historical terms in the Manual, the rule applies to modern outbreaks (e.g., containment zones in pandemic-management orders). Delivery is restricted to the boundary of the containment zone or suspended as per local Health-Authority guidelines.

Rule 75. Forbidden Practices

Village Postmen are forbidden to:

- carry private parcels or letters for the public outside the post;
- demand "bakshish" or tips for delivery;
- allow any unauthorised person to accompany them on their beat.



Quick-Revision Summary — Key Numerical & Statutory Anchors

The following table consolidates the most frequently tested figures, dates and citations across all three parts of Volume VI. Every entry has been verified against the underlying Gazette notification or Government order.

Topic	Current statutory position	Source / authority
Commencement of the Post Office Act, 2023	18 June 2024	Ministry of Communications notification dated 17 June 2024
Post Office Regulations, 2024	Effective 16 December 2024	S.O. 5440(E) dated 16 December 2024
Total sections in Post Office Act, 2023	11 sections	Gazette of India, Act 43 of 2023
Gyan Post — effective date	1 May 2025	G.S.R. 263(E) dated 28 April 2025 (PO 2nd Amendment Regulations, 2025)
Gyan Post — weight range	300 g (min) to 5 kg (max)	Regulation 92A
Gyan Post — tariff range	Rs. 20 to Rs. 100 + GST	PIB release; SOP on Gyan Post
Registered Post merger with Speed Post	Effective 1 September 2025	DoP directive dated 2 July 2025; PIB Fact-Check 7 August 2025
OTP-based delivery (Speed Post)	Rs. 5 + GST per item	PO (Fourth Amendment) Regulations, 2025, S.O. 4375(E) dated 25 September 2025
24 Speed Post Parcel — OTP bundled	Free (between 6 metro cities)	PO (2nd Amendment) Regulations, 2026, S.O. 1329(E) dated 13 March 2026
Single eMO maximum	Rs. 5,000	Schedule I, PO Regulations 2024
Single iMO range	Rs. 1,000 – Rs. 50,000	DoP Financial Services Division

Topic	Current statutory position	Source / authority
MO currency period	1 month following month of issue	Manual Vol VI Pt II
MO forfeiture	1 year from date of issue	Manual Vol VI Pt II; PO Regulations 2024
IPO validity (1st period — no fee)	24 months from last day of month of issue	Rule 180-D, Vol VI Pt II
IPO validity (2nd period — with fee)	24 to 36 months	Rule 180-D
IPO — broken amount stamp affixing	Max 4 stamps; max Rs. 3 total value	Rule 180-B
IPO commission rates	Re. 1 / Rs. 2 / Rs. 5 / Rs. 10 (for Rs. 10 / 20 / 50 / 100)	Post Office Guide, Part II
BPO validity (1st period — no fee)	6 months from last day of month of issue	Rule 196
BPO sale in India	Discontinued	DoP administrative instructions
Speed Post compensation	Double the charges or Rs. 1,000, whichever is less	DoP compensation schedule
International Registered compensation	30 SDR	UPU Convention
Maximum insurance (Speed Post — HO)	Rs. 10,00,000	Financial Services Division Notification
Maximum insurance (Branch PO)	Rs. 600	Financial Services Division Notification
Currency-note insured-post limit	Rs. 20,000	Financial Services Division Notification
V.P. / COD doorstep delivery (Manual figure)	Rs. 500	Vol VI Pt I Rule 203 / Pt III Rule 20
COD maximum (bulk customers)	Rs. 50,000	FS-COD-2025 Notification
Warehousing — V.P. Letters / Packets	Rs. 3 per day	PO Guide, Pt I, Clause 55
Warehousing — V.P. Parcels	Rs. 5 per day	PO Guide, Pt I, Clause 55
Parcel maximum weight (ordinary / accountable)	20 kg	Rule 179

Topic	Current statutory position	Source / authority
Parcel maximum length	1.5 m	India Post Parcel Network Policy
Parcel maximum length + girth	3 m	India Post Parcel Network Policy
Volumetric weight divisor	5,000	India Post Parcel Network Policy
Compulsory registration weight (parcel)	> 4 kg	Rule 156
Cash conveyance — single official by foot	Up to Rs. 2,00,000	Directorate Letter 25-14/2021-Security (2024 update)
Cash conveyance — single official by vehicle	Up to Rs. 5,00,000	Directorate Letter 25-14/2021-Security
Cash conveyance — two officials with armed guard	Above Rs. 5,00,000 up to Rs. 25,00,000	Directorate Letter 25-14/2021-Security
POSB minimum balance — with cheque facility	Rs. 500	Government Savings Promotion General Rules, 2018
POSB minimum balance — without cheque facility	Rs. 50	Government Savings Promotion General Rules, 2018
POSB account maintenance fee (if below minimum)	Rs. 50 per financial year	Government Savings Promotion General Rules, 2018
POSB interest rate (Q4 FY 2025-26)	4.0% per annum	Ministry of Finance interest-rate notification
POSB inoperative threshold	3 financial years	POSB Rules 2019
POSB ATM daily withdrawal	Rs. 25,000	SB Order
POSB counter withdrawal (without supervisor)	Rs. 20,000	SB Order
GDS withdrawal limit (per customer at BO)	Rs. 20,000	SB Order
Deceased claim — Sub-Postmaster (no nomination)	Up to Rs. 50,000	SB Order
Deceased claim — Head Postmaster (no nomination)	Up to Rs. 5,00,000	SB Order

Topic	Current statutory position	Source / authority
Deceased claim – Superintendent (no nomination)	Up to Rs. 10,00,000	SB Order
Dress Allowance (7th CPC)	Rs. 5,000 per annum	DoP Order on PCC dress allowance
Franking machine rebate	3% if monthly consumption > Rs. 5,000	Postal Operations Division
Identification Card fee	Rs. 100	DoP (PO Division) notification
Identification Card validity	3 years	Rule 319
Post Box rent (full FY)	Rs. 150 (Manual rate)	Rule 115
Post Box rent (3 calendar months)	Rs. 50 (Manual rate)	Rule 115
MO paid voucher preservation	18 months	Manual Vol VIII
Bulk MO list preservation	6 months	Manual Vol VIII
Foreign MO record preservation	3 years	Manual Vol VIII
Treasury Remittance Book	10 years	Manual Vol VIII

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